

BOBBY MYERS



chess

2 books in 1



Learn All Fundamentals to Play Chess. Study Your Openings,
Enhance your Attack Strategies and Annihilate Your Opponent.

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FOR BEGINNERS

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OPENINGS
FOR BEGINNERS

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CHESS

2 Books in 1:

*Learn All Fundamentals To
Play Chess Study Your Openings, Enhance
Your Attack Strategies And Annihilate Your
Opponent*

By
Bobby Myers

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Introduction

Chess is a fascinating game between two people, and a strategy board game played for decades. Chess is commonly thought to originate in India around the sixth century during the Gupta Empire. The pieces used in the game depicted their army's four divisions: infantry, cavalry, elephants, and chariot. Now they have grown into the contemporary Pawn, Knight, Bishop, and Rook. The Chess game is so intense and competitive that the International Olympic Committee considers it a sport. I know from my Chess experience it's easy to learn, but it takes years to master.

Chess isn't that bad to learn, but it can be a little difficult because each piece can be moved differently. Chess is played on an eight-row and eight columns square board. The eight rows are called ranks and have numbers 1 to 8. The 8 columns are called files and have letters A to H. The players are named "White" and "Black," and each begins a 16-piece game. Every player starts with two Bishops, one King, two Knights, eight Pawns, one Queen, and two Rooks. To start playing, pieces are moved to an occupied square by a piece of the opponent.

If you place a piece on your opponents' occupied piece, it is taken off the board. If a King is directly attacked by one or two of the enemy's pieces, he is said to be in check, and the game will end. A Chess game is generally divided into three sections: the first 10 to 25 moves (when players move their pieces in positions to the upcoming battle), the middle-game, which they claim is the most exciting part of the game; and the end-game, when the Kings are usually more involved in the combat.

Chess games don't necessarily end when a King's check is finished because both players will leave if they don't believe they can win. Use this simple hint when moving a Chess piece, consider the total worth of pieces on both sides. Then change these moves by factors which suit the position of the job, for example, advanced Pawns are usually more valuable than those on the original squares, the organizing of the objects (for example, a couple of Bishops

generally co-ordinate better than a Bishop and Knight pair), and the position.

Internet Chess has been popularized on various websites since it enables people to play against a computer machine. Online Chess also strengthens the game, allowing a worldwide Chess player community to play regardless of its geographical location or time zone. With so many websites hosting Chess games, it is easy for a person to find an online Chess game or tournament. Chess is one of the world's most famous games, played at home, parties, online, and tournaments by millions worldwide. Often a Chess game may be played for days or weeks.

Chess helps you to see and foresee the results of your actions. The difference between winning and losing the game may be a good Chess strategy. If you wish to know the Chess game fundamentals, it wouldn't be bad to read and digest this beginner's guide.

CHAPTER 1:

The Board and the Goal



The Goal of the Game

The King is the most important piece whose status determines when the game comes to an end. The goal of the game is to get your opponent's King into a position where it is under attack, is unable to move, and cannot be helped by its own men; this is also known as checkmate. Check is when the King is under attack but can escape. The important question is when the King is under attack, what can you or your opponent do? The best way to remember is by using the ABCs.

THE ABCs OF CHECK

AWAY: Runaway with the King to a square where it can't be captured.

BLOCK: Put a piece in between the attacker and the King.

CAPTURE: Capture the piece that is attacking the King.

An important rule to note is that the King can never be captured in Chess. You are also not allowed to put your King into check (move on a square protected by an enemy player). Since this is an illegal move, if a person goes ahead and does this, he or she should take it back and make a legal move instead. It is also illegal to keep your King in check. When your King is under attack, you must stop all plans and protect your most important piece. A player may also resign (give up) in a game by telling the opponent verbally, "I resign!" or putting his or her King down.

But do all Chess games end in a win or lose? No! In fact, the game of Chess allows for six different types of draws:

1. AGREEMENT: You may offer a draw to your opponent after you've made your move. If your opponent accepts, the game has come to an end. If your opponent declines, the game continues.

2. INSUFFICIENT MATERIAL: When both sides don't have enough pieces to checkmate either King, the game ends.

3. 50-MOVE RULE: If a Pawn hasn't been moved or a piece hasn't been captured in 50 moves, either player may claim a draw. The only way to prove this scenario is to have the moves written down or an arbiter monitoring the game.

4. STALEMATE: When a player's King is not in check, and no legal moves can be made, the game ends.

5. PERPETUAL CHECK: When a player checks the King repeatedly and is able to copy the exact same position three times, the game ends.

6. THREE-TIME REPETITION: Copying the exact position three times but without checks results in a draw.

Each of these draws will be covered more in-depth in chapter 5.

The Board

The board consists of 64 squares on an 8-by-8 checkerboard. Half of the squares (32) are light, and the other half is dark. When you are placing the board in front of you, make sure the bottom right-hand corner is light. Just remember the helpful saying, “Light is on the right!” It doesn’t matter whether you are playing White or Black; the right-hand corner square closest to you must always be light. You might notice that there are letters and numbers along the sides of a Chessboard; this is to provide each square on the board with its own name. We use these coordinates to write down our moves but also to participate in Chess conversations.

What is a Chess conversation? If you’re speaking to a friend or your Chess instructor about a position, it is not correct to simply point at a square in discussing it; you must assign it a name.

For example, you would say, “My Knight on c3 could have captured the Pawn on d5.” There are also important terms we use, as well:

FILES: They are the vertical lines that divide the board into eight columns across. These include the a, b, c, d, e, f, g, and h files.

RANKS: They are the horizontal lines that divide the board into eight columns from bottom to top. These include the 1st, 2nd, 3rd, 4th, 5th, 6th, 7th, and 8th rank.

QUEENSIDE AND KINGSIDE: We can also divide the board in half vertically: QUEENSIDE and KINGSIDE. Queenside includes the a, b, c, and d files. Kingside includes the e, f, g, and h files. We might use one of these terms in a sentence, such as, “I castled my King on the Queenside.”

THE STARTING POSITION: Since White always moves first in Chess, its pieces are located on the 1st and 2nd ranks; meanwhile, Black’s pieces are placed on the 7th and 8th ranks.

There have been many explanations as to why White moves first. Personally, the one I like the most is that long ago, before glasses were invented, people preferred to play Black over White because it was easier to see the pieces. As a concession, those playing White could go first.

KING AND QUEEN: The KING and the QUEEN are royalty, so they are positioned in the center of the starting arrangement (d and e files). The King is the piece usually wearing a cross on its head (White’s King: e1; Black’s King: e8), while the Queen wears a tiara or crown (White’s Queen: d1; Black’s Queen: d8). Make sure to place the Queen in its own color!

ROOKS: They are the pieces that look like a tower of a castle. They are placed in the corners of the board since the other pieces live “inside the castle.”

KNIGHTS: They are the pieces that look like a horse. If we look back at medieval times, the high-ranked soldiers will fight on horseback. High-ranked soldiers lived inside the castle with the King, Queen, and Bishops.

BISHOPS: They resemble popes in their attire and zucchetto (skullcap). Back in the day, when religion held a central place in society, Bishop was the common term used in Chess. But today, there are many who are not believers—or are even atheists—so some Chess instructors (including myself) call these pieces “Advisors of the King and Queen,” as the real Bishops would help with any decision-making at the Round Table.

PAWNS: They are the pieces that look like a person without arms. Pawns were known to be low-ranked soldiers, which is why they guard the castle and everyone inside.

CHAPTER 2:

Name, All Moves of the Pieces, Special Rules, and Chess Notations



Rules and Chess Notation

The object of the game is to threaten the opponent's King with a move that will lead to an inevitable capture or checkmate. The player holding the White pieces makes the first move, and the players make alternating moves afterward. Each player is required to make a move at every turn. In major tournaments, a computerized draw is made to determine who will be holding the White pieces.

If the King is in check, the only legal move a defending player can make is to get the King out of check. The player may move the King out of the threatened square, capture the attacking piece, or use another piece to block the attacking piece. The game ends when the King is captured, a draw is declared by an arbiter, or a player resigns.

En Passant

En passant is a Pawn maneuver that allows an opponent to capture

a Pawn “in passing.” It can only happen under the following conditions:

- The capturing Pawn is on the fifth rank.
- The opposing Pawn moves two squares from its first position instead of only one square to avoid capture by the enemy Pawn on the adjacent column.

Instead of replacing the captured piece in its position as in all other instances of capture, the capturing Pawn takes the position that the opponent’s Pawn would have taken had it chosen to advance one square away from its first position. The move to capture the passing Pawn must be made immediately after the opponent’s turn. If it happens to be the only possible legal move, the en passant capture must be made.

Castling

Castling is a maneuver involving the King and one of the Rooks. It is the only Chess move that allows a player to move two pieces in one turn, the only other move where both pieces can mimic the Knight’s ability to jump over other pieces, and the only move where a King is allowed to go two squares away from its original position.

Castling may be done on the King’s side or the Queen’s side. If done on the King’s side, the King moves 2 squares to the right while the Rook moves 2 squares to the left. If carried out on the Queen’s side, the King moves two squares to the left as the Rook simultaneously moves three squares to the right.

Castling is allowed only if all of the following requirements are met:

- The King and the Rook involved are in their original position and have never moved prior to castling.
- There are no pieces on the squares between the Rook and the King.
- The King must not be in check at the time of castling. In other words, castling cannot be used as a move to evade a check. If the player intends to castle, the threat must first be eliminated by either capturing the attacking piece or

blocking it with another piece.

- The King must not end up in a square that will place it in check after castling.

Castling is an important strategy in the opening as it allows the player to move the King to a safer position while simultaneously moving the Rook to a more advantageous attacking position in the center. Kingside castling is generally more preferred because it requires less movement to accomplish, places the King in a relatively safer position closer to the board's edge, and allows the King to support all three Pawns on the castled side.

If it's not possible to castle as in cases where either the King or the Rook were forced to move before, they can castle, a player may prefer to keep the King safe by taking additional moves to accomplish what is called Artificial Castling.

Moving the Pieces

Only one hand should be used to move the pieces. Once the piece is released on a square, the player will not be able to retract the move unless it is illegal. Castling is done by moving the King first with one hand and moving the Rook using the same hand. Once a Pawn has been released on the eighth row to promote it, the player is obliged to promote the Pawn by replacing it with a new piece. The promotion is not final until a new piece is placed on the square.

Touch-Move Rule

While the rule is not strictly followed in informal games, the touch-move rule is in effect during serious games. Under the rule, provided that the piece can be moved legally, the player must move a piece once it is touched. If the player touches an opponent's piece, the piece should be captured if there is a possible legal move to do so. If there are no available legal moves to capture or move a piece, no penalty is imposed on the player. A player who wishes to touch a piece to adjust its position on the square must first inform the opponent of his intention to adjust the piece before doing so. A player may only touch a piece for whatever purpose when it is his or her turn to move.

The touch-move rule likewise applies during castling. A player who touches the Rook and the King at the same time must castle using the same Rook provided the move is legal. If the King moves two squares towards the direction of a Rook, the Rook must be moved to complete the castling. If the castling is illegal, the King must be returned to its original place. The player must then move the King if there is a possible legal move.

Check and Stalemate

Each player strives to capture the opponent's King to win the game. When the King is under threat of capture by an opponent's piece, it is said to be 'in check.' The 'check' is generally announced in informal games, but this is not required during competitions. Once under 'check,' the player must immediately address the threat. Here are possible moves to get out of check:

- Move the King to a safe square.
- Block the path of the attacking piece by placing another piece in between. Take note that this option is not possible if the attacker is a Knight or a Pawn. A piece used to block the threatening piece may simultaneously place the enemy King under check.
- Capture the attacking piece if another piece is in a position to do so. The King itself may make the capture if the action does not place it under check. Take note that it is illegal to move the King in a square where it will be placed immediately under threat of capture.

If it becomes impossible to get the King out of check, it is 'checkmated,' and the game ends. The player with the 'checkmated' King loses the game.

Draws

A draw is a tied game in which neither player wins the game. A draw may be automatic or claimed. A draw is invoked using the following rules:

- Stalemate.
- 50-move rule.

- Threefold repetition.
- Checkmate impossibility.
- Mutual agreement.

A stalemate may occur if the player taking a turn is not in check but lacks the option to make a legal move. This situation results in an automatic draw. The game may also end in a draw when both players have made 50 moves each without a capture or a Pawn's movement. The draw may be claimed by either player. If the position is repeated thrice by the same player, he or she can claim a draw. The claim should be made before the third move is made. Otherwise, the player will lose the opportunity to claim a draw. A player who decides not to invoke the three-fold repetition rule may claim a draw afterward in the game if a similar opportunity presents itself. In 2014, FIDE added a rule that allowed an automatic draw in cases where the positions are repeated by both players for five consecutive turns. The game may also end in a draw if neither player lacks the capability to checkmate the other player based on the remaining Chess pieces. For instance, it will be impossible for the game to result in a checkmate if the remaining pieces are King versus King, King versus King and Knight, King versus King and Bishop, and both Kings with a Bishop each on the same square color. A King may still win when left with a Pawn if the Pawn can be promoted. Any player can offer a draw at any point in the game, but a draw will only be declared if both players agree.

Resigning

A player may opt to resign anytime during the game. The decision to resign is usually made if the player foresees an inevitable loss either by a checkmate or time expiration. A player may either verbally state his wish to resign or tip the King on its side.

Time Control

The length of a Chess game is controlled with a timer or a digital game clock. FIDE, the World Chess Federation, sets a limit of 90 minutes for the initial forty moves and an additional thirty minutes for the remainder of the match with an increment of thirty seconds

per move counting from the first move. This is for standard games, however, and game time may always be adjusted for special games. Informal Chess games are usually played without the benefit of a game clock.

Recording Chess Games

The moves in a Chess game can be recorded and described using different methods. The present standard is Algebraic Notation, but you may also come across old Chess books using Descriptive Notation. Recording is required in official Chess competitions for use in case of disputes or in situations where the application of Chess rules require information on the type and number of moves made. Knowing how to record and read Chess games is important if you seriously want to improve your playing skills. By writing your own games, you will be able to recheck your moves and have the game replayed. Knowledge of notation will also allow you to study and learn from great games played by champion players.

The Algebraic Notation

Each square on the Chessboard is assigned a unique code. The columns (files) of squares starting from the leftmost column on the Queen’s side going to the right are labeled a-h while the rows (ranks) starting from the White’s side are numbered 1-8. The position of a piece is identified by the coordinate letter-number pair. For instance, the White Queen’s starting position is on d1—the square located on the fourth file and first rank. The Black King’s starting position is on e8—the square on the fifth and eighth ranks. You will use the following standard symbols in reading or recording Chess games:

• K	King
• Q	Queen
• R	Rook
• N	Knight
• B	Bishop
• x	Captures

• +	Check
• ++ or #	Checkmate
• ep	En passant
• O-O	Castling on the Kingside
• O-O-O	Castling on the Queenside

CHAPTER 3:

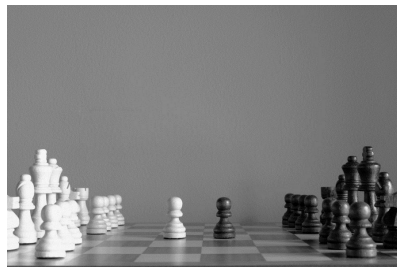
Strategies on How to Control the Board

Chess is a fantastic game that requires aptitude and focus. Numerous individuals play Chess for no particular reason, yet numerous Chess competitions offer players the chance to flaunt their aptitudes. The game looks basic and is played on a square Chessboard, with an eight-by-eight lattice that contains 64 squares. Every player has sixteen pieces to play toward the start of the game. Typically, one set is white and the other dark to keep them dark. The motivation behind this game is to make rivals lord in what is known as a "partner," and this implies he has been assaulted, and there is no spot to move.

How to Get a Chess Game?

Review

An opponent is investigated when an opponent puts his Chess piece in the position to capture the King. If the King cannot be removed from the check, then the "control officer" is considered.



Verification Officer

Checkmate is the goal of Chess and the only way to win this game. The pledge is when a King is attacked and has no means to evade control; any piece that blocks the attack or any piece to get the opposite piece is a threat to the King's threat. Below are the main abbreviations used in the Chess symbol:

- King: K

- Queen: S
- Rook: R
- Bishop: b
- Knight: N
- Pedestrian: P
- For: -
- Check: chap
- Registration: x
- Discovered: Review
- Double-check: dbl ch
- By the way: e.g.
- Castles, King: 0--0
- Castle, Queen: 0-0-0-0-0
- Good move: !
- Perfect move: !!
- Prominent movement: !!!
- Inappropriate movement: ?

Here are some examples of acronyms: N - KB3 means "The Knight moves to the King of three Bishops." Q x B means "Queen takes the Bishop." R - K8ch means "Rook to check eight Kings." Procedures are frequently mistaken for strategies and the other way around. Be that as it may, there are a few contrasts between the two. The strategy makes the most of the transient open doors that become obvious during the game.

For instance, you may find that your rival has left an increasingly important piece before a progressively significant piece. Scan the board and find that the less valuable piece is not protected. So, if you decide to go for it cheaply and risk the low bandwidth, you are fooling yourself.

On the other hand, strategies help you develop a plan to deal with your opponent's army throughout the game. Of course, you don't know exactly what your opponent will do before the game starts. Therefore, you must be prepared to adapt to your plans and, if necessary, change the Intermediate Game Strategies.

The next set of strategies should be used to get you wrong about what you can do or how to react, to deal with everything your opponent shows you. You cannot bear it to be rigid, with only one

program or strategy; you have to adapt to the flow of the game. As Bruce Lee said, "Water looks weak, but it can penetrate the rock. Be like the nature of water." It sounds simple, but without the right strategies, you can see your own self in a suitcase more than just being the winner of the game. Here are 15 procedures that can enable you to win more.

Strategy 1: Make time to find out what parts are and how much each one is worth. Sometimes you have to give up men to get men, and if you give up men with less value than you decide, you'll be ahead of the game.

Strategy 2: Get started on foot. Pedestrians are usually the first to move, and your strategy should begin here with rules that are part of Chess. Pedestrians can move a space forward unless it is the first move the pedestrian makes in play, then the pedestrian can move two zones. The Pawn on the ground can move in a region slantingly in front. On the off chance that a Pawn on the ground happens to arrive at the opposite side of the board, it can be used as part of a player's selection.

Strategy 3: Plan your strategy to defend your King. The main goal of this match is to defend your King and gain control over your opponent's King. Remembering this from the beginning will help you better plan your moves.

Strategy 4: Watch every move your rival makes and ponder about how each and every one of them will benefit. It will help you cope with their movements, as you can see through their strategy.

Strategy 5: A common phrase in Chess is "Who controls the center controls the game."

If you control Chess at the start of each match, you can use the top game. By controlling the center, four squares will usually be handy. Remember this when arranging your system.

Nonetheless, this doesn't imply that in the event that you don't have a piece on the board, you will lose the round of Chess, which implies that it is progressively alluring to need a large portion of the pieces in the focal point of the board. Placing the Chess pieces in the middle of the Chessboard will give you more room to record

your opponent's pieces and make it difficult for you to operate the on-board monitor.

Strategy 6: Find out when you lose track will benefit from the game. E.g., if you can use a little to give your opponent more value, it is worth sacrificing.

Strategy 7: Before moving each track, consider how much movement will affect a particular record in the next game. If the path is already in good condition, you may have to come back to it and move to another location. Some beginners make the mistake of not chewing any Chess piece like theirs. Note that each Chess piece plays a significant part in the Chess game. Otherwise, they will not come into play. Also, try and make sure you know the relative value of each Chess piece. The base value is as follows:

- A Pawn is worth 1.
- A Knight is worth 3.
- A Bishop is worth 3.
- A Rook is worth 5.
- A Queen is worth 9.
- The King is infinitely valuable.

Strategy 8: Each piece has its strengths and weaknesses. We need to send them to a place where their powers can be used. Knights are short pieces. They need support points (provided by Powers) to reach their goals. Knights must be ranked sixth when attacking an enemy camp. However, categories 1 and 2 are intended for defensive work. Grades 3, 4, and 5 serve for offensive and defensive responsibilities. Bishops need long, clear diagonals to be effective.

Rooks to cause the most damage to enemy territory, in category 7. Open files must be in line 7. Queens have the best range of motion on the entire board. They can go anywhere very fast. If possible, consider playing the Queen when the enemy forces are significantly reduced. After the enemy's King is hunted, the Queen can practically offer and support the remaining forces. Kings are vulnerable in the early and middle stages of the game. However, when the game is transferred to the Endgame stage, but there are some of your opponent Pawns, and only one or two pieces, the

King's power is fully realized. At this point, take the King to the middle of the Chessboard, use it to select the infantry, and, if possible, use the King to help one of your infantry advances.

Strategy 9: The Queen's failure to move early in the game is part of the Chess strategy's critical points for beginners. Most beginners try to move the Queen, creating mating threats at f7 or f2. These threats are usually unrealistic, and a player who is touching the Queen is often missing trying to get the Queen back in a safe field. You've probably heard that before. But "don't change your Queen too soon" is a rule that can sometimes be eliminated. For example, if your rival commits a big mistake, you can immediately punish the Queen by starting the attack.

Strategy 10: The ability to identify when each particular piece didn't have a bright future is an essential aspect of a Chess strategy at all levels. It makes the dissimilarity between the beginner players and the masters. When a Bishop is blocked by his pedestrians because they are in squares of the same color as the Bishop, the Bishop is usually considered a stinker. It is a wise decision to change it with another piece of the same amount whenever possible. When the situation is significant, the Bishops tend to have better pieces than the Knights. Knights in closed conditions tend to be better parties because they are the only ones who can jump more than other parties.

Strategy 11: Don't be greedy! Sometimes you find it easy to walk, but it can be a trap ("poisonous ride"). Acceptance often allows the opponent a powerful attack and is often the greatest method to prevent the return of the material instead of trying to keep it.

Strategy 12: Avoid sudden attacks on your opponent. Most games are probably destroyed by beginners ignoring this principle for any other reason. The attack should never be performed, as long as there is enough force to reach the final result, and an early attack will almost inevitably return to the attacker's head.

Strategy 13: Look for the weaknesses in the opponent's position. The ability to recognize the opponent's fault and make full use of it is also part of the necessary skills of Chess. If the situation on the table allows (unfortunately, sometimes not), try to complicate the

game - look for threats, small combinations, accentuate your position, increase your pressure, and sacrifice yourself for the initiative.

Each of these "techniques" creates new problems for the adversary, and he must deal with them. The worst - you have to deal with them in a few seconds and elevate your possibility of success. Sometimes even when your threat is not right. But will your opponent have the option to discover him with his falling flag? Of course, it all depends on the specific situation of the council. So, with the ideas mentioned in your mind, do not pay attention to your subtle threats and differences. It's a pity to play for a few hours and then to waste it in a matter of seconds.

Strategy 14: If you are serious about improving the game, change your lifestyle. "You can stop smoking and stop drinking." And a little exercise is not harmful. "Since games last between four and six hours, you have to stay focused for that moment - and if you're not physically fit, it's hard to do."

Strategy 15: To win this game, you must launch an assault on your rival King. When attacked, he is under control. If the King loses power, the game is still alive. When the King can no longer get out of control, the King checks and the game is over.

CHAPTER 4:

The Phases of the Game

The Opening

Remember our seven rules for playing a good opening:

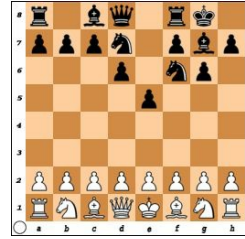
1. Develop all of your pieces!
2. Control the center.
3. Don't bring your Queen out too early.
4. Get your King castled as soon as possible.
5. Move each piece only once in the opening.
6. Develop your Knights before Bishops.
7. Don't move your Pawn in the opening unless you have to remember our recommended openings. If you want a solid opening plan that you can use every time for White:

Kings Indian Attack 1. E4, 2. d3, 3. Nd2, 4. Ngf3 5. g3, 6. Bg2, 7. 0—0



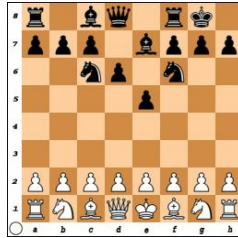
For Black: Kings Indian Defense (against all white moves except 1. e4)

1. Nf6, 2. d6, 3. g6, 4. Bg7, 5. 0-0, 6. Nbd7, 7. e5



Or Hungarian Defense (against 1. e4)

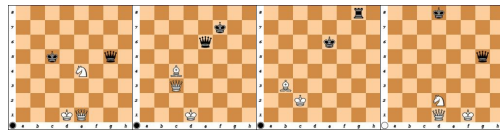
1. e5, 2. Nc6, 3. Be7, 4. Nf6, 5. d6, 6. 0-0



The Middle Game

To improve in the middle game, remember to keep practicing tactics:

Material tactics: Make sure you look for forks, pins, skewers, and discovered attacks.



Mating tactics: Remember to look for different mating tactics, for example, Anastasia's mate, Legall's mate, Greco's mate, or smothered mate.



Or look for combinations of tactics:



When there are no tactics available in a middle game, you'll have to use middle game planning.

By practicing middle game planning while you are playing your games, you'll get better and better at it.

Here are some examples of middle game plans you can use:

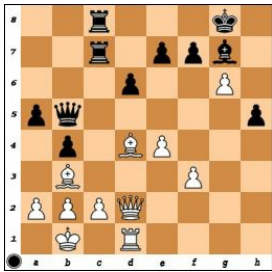
1. Checkmate Attack! - Move your pieces towards the opponent's King and attack and try to checkmate.



2. Gain Space by advancing your Pawns - Advance your Pawns on one side to gain space on that side so that your pieces have more mobility and more options and your opponent's pieces have less mobility.



3. Advance both Pawns and pieces towards your opponent's King and attack (risky but not unheard of).



4. Advance Pawns on a side where you have a majority of Pawns - (i.e., a 3 to 2 majority as shown below) in order to create a passed Pawn and try to Queen that Pawn.



5. Place your Rooks on an open file and attack - use your Rooks to attack down an open file.



6. Attack weaknesses on your opponent's side (usually this means attacking weak Pawns).



7. Control the Centre - Use Pawns and pieces to attack the Centre, which will often give you better chances to attack and win material or checkmate the opponent.



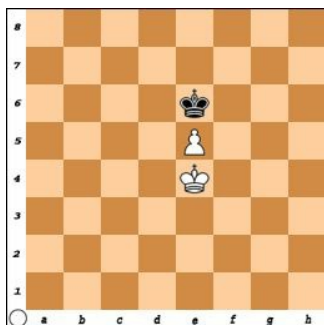
The Endgame

Remember the endgame lessons that we learned about the four basic mates:

1. Two Rooks VS. King.
2. Rook VS. King.
3. Two Bishops VS. King.
4. Knight and Bishop VS. King (Ok, it doesn't really matter if you don't remember this one - it isn't easy).

Pawn Endgames: Pawn endgame skills are very important to remember. We learned a lot of Pawn endgame lessons, but these ones, in particular, are important for you to remember:

King + Pawn VS. King:



This is a very important endgame for you to remember. Remember our rules of the King + Pawn VS. King Endgame:

Rule 1: If the black King can get to the square directly in front of the White Pawn, or the square in front of that, black will draw.

Rule 2: White wins if two or more of the following conditions are met:

- A) White's King is in front of the Pawn.
- B) White has the opposition.
- C) White's King is on the 6th rank. (The one exception is a Pawn is a flank Pawn, where black can usually draw if he can get in front of

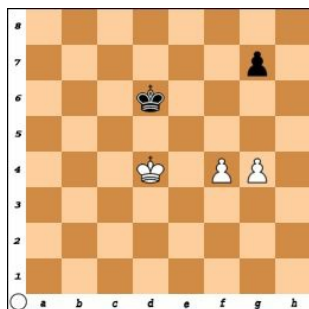
the Pawn).

Rule 3: The worst Pawn for white to have is the flank Pawn, where invariably black draws.

Rule 4: It is always an advantage to have the opposition for both white and black.

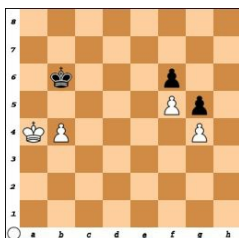
Rule 5: It is always an advantage to have the King in front of the Pawn for both white and black

King + 2 Pawns VS. King + Pawn:



Remember how to win this endgame. Advance the Pawn with no Pawn opposing it first; then, at the right moment, you'll have to sacrifice one of your Pawns to win the game.

Multiple Pawn endgames with Pawns on both sides.

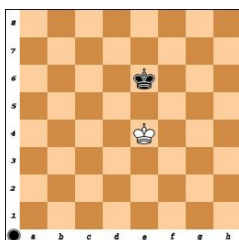


Use the passed Pawn as bait, and then switch your King over to the other side to win your opponent's Pawns.



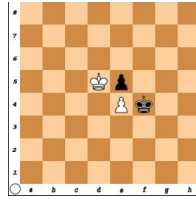
Remember to act immediately on the side where you have more forces (in this case, the Kingside). Remember important Pawn endgame concepts: The Opposition, Trebuchet, and Outside Passed Pawns.

The Opposition:



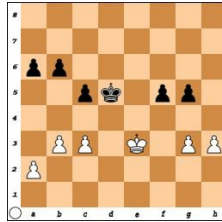
Here it's black's move, and black's King has to move away, so white has the opposition. It's usually an advantage to have the opposition, so try to make sure you have it.

Trebuchet:



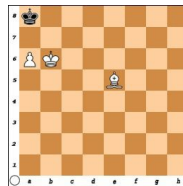
The Trebuchet Position. Whoever's turn it is to move, that person loses. It is white to move, and so white loses in this position.

Outside passed Pawn:



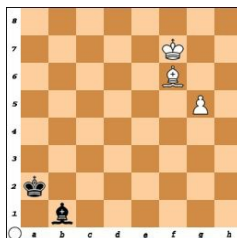
White will win here by creating an outside passed Pawn, which he can use as bait and then switch his King over to the other side to win black's Pawns.

Bishop draws:



Remember that a Bishop and a flank Pawn with a Queening square of the opposite color to the Bishop cannot force mate on a lone King. This can help you save a draw even when you are losing by a lot!

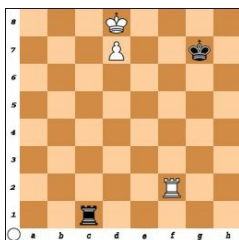
Opposite colored Bishops:



Opposite colored Bishops offer good drawing chances to a player if he is down 1 or 2 Pawns. Your opponent's Bishop cannot control the squares that your Bishop is controlling, so you have good chances of stopping your opponent's Pawns.

Rook Endgames: Rook endgames are the most important endgames of them all because they are so common. We looked at a lot of different Rook endgame skills, some of which were very complex, but even if you forget everything else, try to remember the Lucena position, the Philidor position, Pigs on the 7th rank, Tarrasch rule, and Rook and Multiple Pawn endgames:

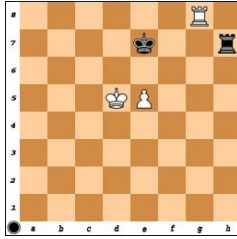
The Lucena position: The Lucena position is important to learn because it teaches us how to win an endgame where we have a Rook and Pawn vs. a lone Rook.



A definition of a Lucena position is when White has a Pawn on the 7th rank (the Pawn can be on any file except on the flanks - if the Pawn is a flank Pawn, then the position is generally a draw) and white's King is in front of his Pawn, blocking the Pawn from Queening. White's Rook is two files to the Pawn side and is cutting the black King off from getting near the white Pawn. Black's Rook is behind the white Pawn.

White wins by the "building a bridge technique." By playing Rf4! in the above position, white's King can come out, and white's Rook can eventually block white's King from checks.

The Philidor position: The Philidor position is important to learn because it teaches us how to draw when we have a lone Rook vs. Rook and Pawn (essentially the opposite of a Lucena situation).

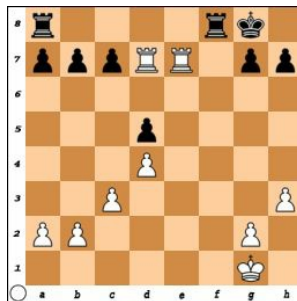


Definitions of a Philidor position:

- The defending King (in this case, the black King) is in front of the enemy Pawn (the Pawn can be on any file).
- The attacking Pawn is no further advanced than its 5th rank (i.e., if it is a white Pawn, then it is no further advanced than the 5th rank, and if it is a black Pawn, then it is not further than the 4th rank).
- The attacking King is no further advanced than its 5th rank.
- The defending Rook is on the 6th rank, stopping the attacking King from advancing (if the defending Rook were a white Rook, then, of course, it would be on the 3rd rank).

Black draws by keeping his Rook on the 6th rank. Once white advances his Pawn, black moves his Rook to the back rank and bombards white's King with checks from the back rank perpetually.

Pigs on the 7th/2nd rank:

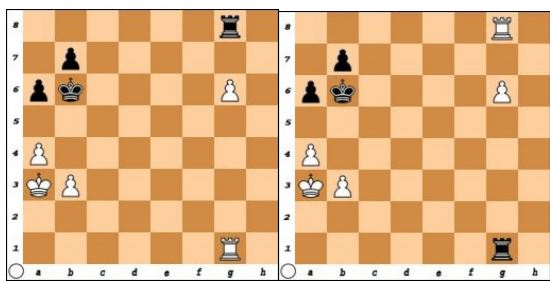


Having 2 Rooks on the 7th rank is a very good idea.

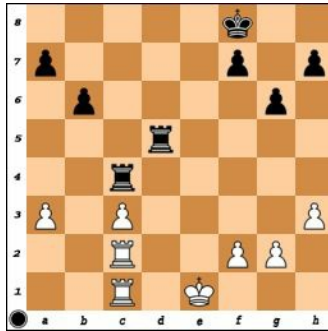
Tarrasch rule: Always place your Rook behind a passed Pawn.

This applies whether the Pawn is your own Pawn or your opponent's Pawn; it is almost always a good idea to have your

Rook behind the passed Pawn.



Rook and multiple Pawn endgames:



Studying Rook and multiple Pawn endgames will make you a master Chess player.

How to think:

Before you make each move remember our 6-step checklist to deciding what move to make:

1. Check for threats! (Think about what your opponent is trying to do).
2. Look for tactics.
3. Development, development, development.
4. Look for pieces activity.
5. Think about strategic planning.
6. Check for threats again!

How to Attack the Opponent and How to Defend from that Attack (Part I)

A typical Chess game involves attacking your opponent's pieces and defending your own pieces. Your major aim of attacking your opponent's pieces is to gain a chance to checkmate his King.

Your major aim of defending your own pieces is to have enough powerful pieces that can defend your own King, seeing as the King is one of the less powerful pieces on the board.

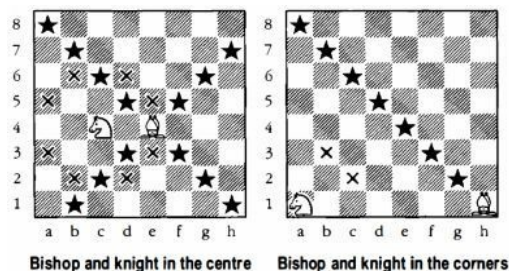
Additionally, when playing Chess, it is not just about attacking and defending pieces; you have to consider the quality of the pieces you are attacking and defending. It is foolish to lose your Queen while protecting your Pawn. So, it is more of a game of quality than quantity.

Yes, having pieces on your side can help you protect your King, but nothing beats having powerful pieces, even if they are just a few.

So, before you make a move, you have to pause, think, and critically judge the move. You will need to ask yourself, what do I stand to gain or lose with this move? Will this move open up my King or any of my other pieces to attack? Will this move help me to weaken my enemy's defense? These and more are some of the questions that should always go through your mind when you are considering making a move.

The Mobility of Pieces on an Empty Board

Even though you have seen how the different pieces move on an empty board, we want to refresh your memory by revisiting the topic.



Most Chess pieces perform better and wield more power when they are in the center of the board than anywhere else. When a piece sits in the center, there are many squares that the piece, in particular, can move to.

In the first diagram shown above, you can see that the Knight and Bishop are occupying a central position on the board. The stars drawn on the board shows the number of squares that the Bishop controls. The cross drawn on the board shows the different squares that the Knights' control from its central position. The Bishop easily controls 13 squares while sitting on the 4e-square while the Knight controls eight.

In the second diagram, we have moved the Knight and the Bishop to the first rank. Again, we used stars to show the number of squares that the Bishop controls and crosses to show the number of squares that the Knight controls. As you can see, the number of squares that the two pieces control has reduced drastically, and it was simply due to a change of position. While on the first rank, the Knight controls only two squares, and the Bishop controls only seven.

Comparing the Mobility of Different Pieces

Piece	Centre Moves	Edge Moves	Corner Moves	Reduction in Mobility
Rook	14	14	14	0%
Queen	27	21	21	22%
Bishop	13	7	7	46%
King	8	5	3	63%
Knight	8	4	2	75%

The table shown above illustrates the number of squares that a

Chess piece can control when the piece is making a center move, and when the piece is moving from the edge.

The values shown above are only attainable if the board is empty, so we are assuming an empty board. When you look closely at the figures, you will notice that the Rook is rarely affected by position.

Whether it is at the end, center, or a corner, the Rook will still be able to control 14 squares on an empty board.

The Queen’s location on the board affects the number of moves the piece can make, although the difference is not much.

The Bishop is one piece that loses much of its strength or power when it is not in the center of an empty board. Once a Bishop finds himself at the edge of the board, the number of squares he can control reduces from 13 to 7, a significant number.

The most affected piece among all is the Knight. When in a center position on an empty board, the Knight can move to 8 different squares, but when the piece is in a corner, he can only move to two squares.

Giving Pieces a Numerical Value

Piece	Value
Queen	9
Rook	5
Bishop	3
Knight	3
Pawn	1
King	not relevant

In Chess, it is important to recognize that all pieces are not equal in strength. This will help you when attacking and defending pieces, so you don’t lose a powerful piece while trying to defend a less powerful one. The figures above show the almost universally accepted numerical values of each Chess piece. Since the King cannot be captured or traded in a game, it doesn’t have an assigned numerical value or strength.

As expected, the Queen is the most powerful piece on the board, with a numerical value of 9. The Pawn, as seen earlier, is the lowliest of the pieces, with only a numerical value of 1. When you look at these values, it is easy to see that the Queen is worth about a Rook, a Bishop, and a Pawn. The worth of a Knight can be equated to the worth of three Pawns. A single Rook can be equated to two Pawns and a Knight or Bishop.

It is important to state that the value of a Chess piece might change depending on the position of the piece on the board. For instance, when trapped in a locked position, the Knight will have more value than the Rook. But in an open board or position, the Rook will definitely be more valued than the Knight.

Safe Moves

In Chess, a safe move is simply one that doesn't give your opponent the chance to gain material advantage. Learning how to make safe moves is one of the fundamental skills you must acquire as a Chess player.

Remember, your opponent is always out to attack, weaken your defenses, and checkmate your King, and it is your job to stop that from happening.

One thing you should try to avoid when playing is allowing your piece to be captured for no return.

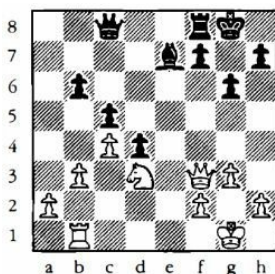
If your piece must be captured, make sure you capture your opponent's own that is of equal or higher value.

When most beginners are playing, they mostly allow their pieces to be captured for no return. In Chess, this is referred to as leaving your pieces "en prise." Here are the two most important questions you must always ask yourself when making a move with a piece:

1. If I move this piece now, can it be captured by my opponent's piece?
2. If I move this piece, will it open up my other pieces to be captured or attacked?

While these two important questions can help you make safer moves, they don't tell the entire story.

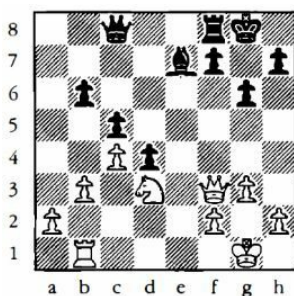
Making safe moves #1



In the above diagram, it is the turn of White to play. Let's look at some possible moves he can make. 1 Nf4 and 1 Ne5 are perfectly safe moves as there are no threats to the Knights in those new squares. Also, the moves will not open up White's other pieces to attack.

Now, if White plays 1 Nb4, you can see that it is an unsafe move. Why is it unsafe? The enemy Pawn on c5 can capture the Knight. If that happens, it means that White sacrificed a powerful Knight for no return at all.

If White plays 1 Qe4 and 1 Qd5, then they are safe moves. However, if White plays 1 Qc6, then that's an unsafe move. It is unsafe because the enemy Queen on c8 can capture the Queen on c6.



Playing 1 h4 will be seen as a complex move because the Pawn can be attacked and captured by the enemy Bishop on e7. But then, white will be able to retaliate by using the g3-Pawn to capture the enemy Bishop on h4.

When speaking materially, White will gain three points from the above move and lose just one. So, the 1 h4 move can be considered a safe one. How did White gain three points? Because he captured an enemy's Bishop, while the enemy only captured White's Pawn. Remember that the Bishop's numerical value is 3 while Pawn's numerical strength is 1. So, White only lost one point and gained 3.

Safe moves #2



In the diagram shown above, it is White's turn to play. If White plays 1 Nd4, what will happen? Black will use his Rook on d8 to capture the Knight (1 Rxd4). White can recapture Black's Rook by playing 2 Qxd4.

Speaking materially, this move makes White lose a Knight (which is 3 points) and gains five points because it captured an enemy's Rook, which has a numerical value of 5. So, the material "balance" of that move made by White is 2. i.e., (5 minuses 3 = 2). So, 1 Nd4 is a safe move.

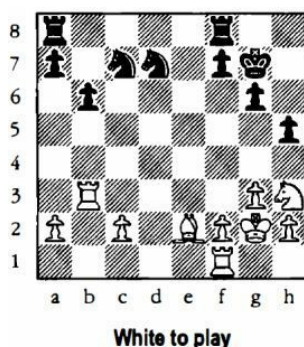
If White had played 1 Qd4, then that would not be a safe move. The reason is that Black will retaliate by playing 1 Rxd4. Then White would make a second move by playing 2 Nxd4. This move is not safe because White gained 5 points but lost 9, incurring a loss of 4 points.

Finally, 1 b4 is yet another unsafe move. The reason is that even though the Pawn moved cannot be captured by an opponent, White has by that move left the a4-Pawn undefended—and it can be captured by either the enemy Bishop or Rook.

CHAPTER 6:

How to Attack the Opponent and How to Defend from that Attack (Part II)

Threatening Your Opponent's Pieces

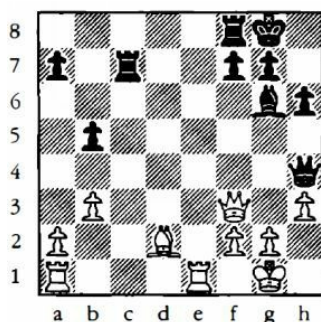


It is not just enough to learn how to make safe moves; to win a Chess game, you will need to know how to threaten or attack your opponent's pieces. This doesn't mean you should attack blindly – just like safe moves; you have to make calculated attacks that wouldn't see you losing more points than you gain. In the diagram shown above, it is White's turn to play. If White wants to attack the undefended black Knight on d7, he can move in four possible ways. See if you can spot the four possible ways.

If White plays 1 Rd1 or 1 Rd3, those are safe moves. If White plays 1 Bb5, that's also a safe move. If White plays 1 Bb5, Black can capture the Bishop using a Knight by playing 1 Nxb5. White will have to recapture b5 using a Rook by playing 2 Rxb5. For this particular move, the overall material gain/loss is zero.

The fourth possibility of attacking the d7-Knight will involve White playing 1 Bg4. But that's not a safe move as White could easily reply with 1... hxd4. After this move, White would lose 3 points. So, it cannot be considered to be a safety threat.

Making Safe Threats

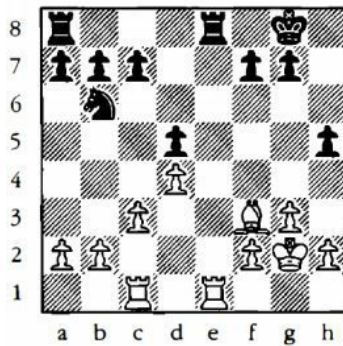


White to play

The importance of issuing safe threats to your opponent's pieces cannot be overemphasized. In Chess, you have to take the battle to your enemy, but you must do it calculatedly. In the diagram above, it is the turn of White to play—we are going to analyze the various ways in which White can issue safe threats to Black. White's target here is Black's Rook on c7.

If White plays 1 Ba5 or 1 Bf4, those are safe moves. In the case of the latter, if Black plays 1 Qxf4, White can retaliate the attack by playing 2 Qxf4. This second move will see White making a net gain of 6 points. Other first moves that White can make include 1 Rac1 or 1 Rec1. In each of these cases, black can capture one of the Rooks, and White will retaliate by recapturing Black's piece on c1. This will see White making a net gain of zero points. When players make a net gain of zero in Chess, it is called a trade or exchange. It is similar to just exchanging or trading pieces. Finally, if on White's first move, he plays 1 Qg4 or 1 Qf4, those are safe threats because the moves give Black the opportunity to trade Queens. If on the first move, White plays 1 Qc3 or 1 Qc6, those are definitely unsafe threats. I will leave you to figure out why those threats are unsafe (look at the diagram to figure it out).

Capturing Your Opponent's Pieces



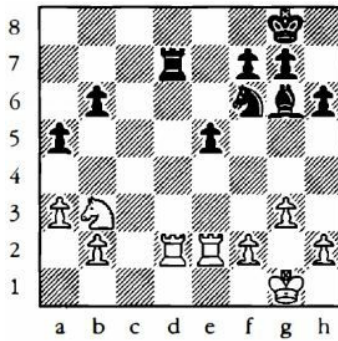
A choice of captures

In addition to protecting your pieces and issuing safe threats, another critical skill you need to learn as a Chess player is how to capture the right pieces. With this skill, you will know the types of pieces you should capture and those you should leave alone for your own good. In the diagram shown above, it is White's turn to play, and he has the chance of capturing three pieces on the board; let's quickly analyze the captures that would make the most sense for White.

If White plays 1 Bxd5, that will be a totally unsafe capture. The reason is that Black will definitely reply by playing 1 Nxd5. This means that White traded a Bishop for a Pawn. Remember, the numerical value of a Bishop is 3, while that of a Pawn is 1. So, White will lose 3 points for playing 1 Bxd5.

However, if White plays 1 Rxe8+, that's a safe move—the move will also see White checking Black's King. Black will recapture by playing 1 Rxe8. So, 1 Rxe8+ is a safe move as the two players simply traded their Rooks with each other. If White plays 1 Bxh5, then it can be considered a safety threat in terms of material gain because White will gain one point.

Good, Safe, and Unsafe Captures

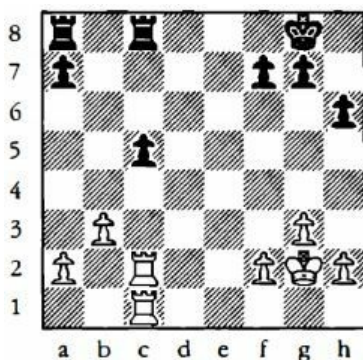


Three possible captures

The diagram shown above is yet another example where White the chance of has made three captures. Let's see the three possible captures and analyze the ones that are good, safe, and unsafe. If White plays 1 Nxa5, that will be an unsafe capture because Black will recapture by playing 1bxa5. This will make white lose 2 points because he simply traded a Knight for a Pawn.

If White plays 1 Rxd7, then that's considered a safe capture – the reason for that shouldn't be hard for you to guess. Black will recapture by playing 1 Nxd7. So, none of the parties gained or lost because they simply traded their Rooks. If White plays 1 Rxe5, then that's an excellent move because White will gain one point by capturing the Pawn on e5 without losing a piece.

Attackers and Defenders

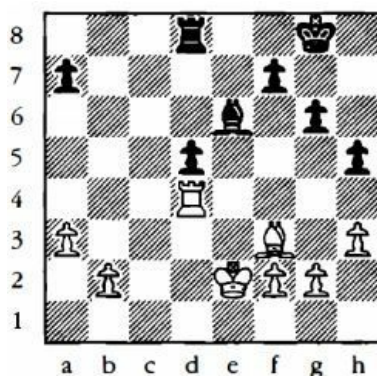


White to play

One good practice you should always adopt when considering whether to capture a threatened piece or not is to calculate in your head what you stand to gain or lose by capturing the threatened piece. For instance, you have to consider all the pieces that are guarding or defending the threatened piece and also consider all the pieces that are attacking it. Now, subtract the number of pieces defending the threatened one from those that are attacking it. If the answer you get from this calculation is zero, then that's an indication that the piece can be safely captured.

Look at the diagram shown above; you can see that White's two Rooks are attacking the black Pawn sitting on c5. On the same c-file is a black Rook defending the threatened Pawn. If White decides to capture the Pawn on c5, then that's a safe move. White will have to play 1 Rxc5, and Black will recapture by playing 1 Rxc5. White will make a second move and play 2 Rxc5, which will earn him a point because he captured a Pawn.

Number of Attackers vs. Number of Defenders

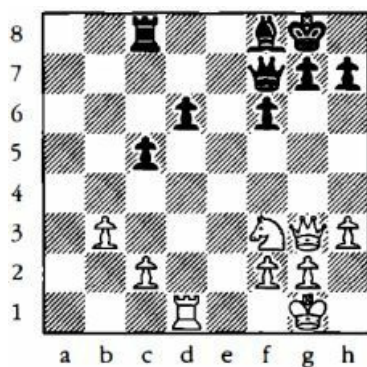


Should White capture?

In the above diagram, White's Rook on d4 and Bishop on f3 are threatening Black's Pawn on d5. While Black's Rook on d8 and Bishop on e6 are defending the black Pawn on d5, the question now is: should White attack that black Pawn on d5? The answer is NO because White has two pieces attacking the Pawn, while Black has the same number of pieces defending the Pawn. If White attacks that black Pawn, he will incur losses. Let's see how that can happen.

For his first move, White plays 1 Bxd5. Black will recapture by playing 1 Bxd5. For his second move, White plays 2 Rxd5 while Black will recapture by playing 2 Rxd5. Black loses a Pawn and a Bishop at the end of the two moves while White loses a Bishop and a Rook. The total number of losses on Black's side would be 4, while the total number of losses on White's side would be 8. So, White will lose four points.

Value of Attackers vs. Value of Defenders



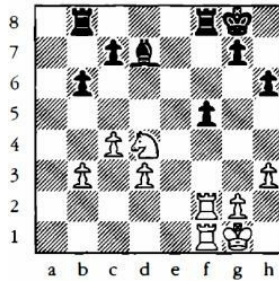
Should White capture on d6?

In addition to checking the number of pieces defending a threatened piece versus the number of pieces that are attacking the threatened piece, you should have to evaluate the value of attackers vs. the value of defenders. In the diagram shown above, the black Pawn on d6 is being attacked by two White's pieces, the Queen on g3 and the Rook on d1. However, the only piece defending the black Pawn is the black Bishop on f8.

If White plays 1 Rxd6, Black plays 1 Bxd6. Then White plays 2 Qxd6; you will observe that white only gained four points and lost five. So, White made a net loss of one point even though he had more pieces attacking a threatened black Pawn. In the above example, you can see why it is always important to consider the value of attackers versus that of defenders.

How to Attack the Opponent and How to Defend from that Attack (Part III)

Capturing in the Correct Order



How should White capture?

In addition to the many other factors, you should consider when capturing pieces described above, another important nut you must crack before capturing a piece is deciding which capture should come first. In other words, you need to calculate which piece to use for the first capture. In the diagram shown above, White's three pieces (the two Rooks on the f-file and the Knight on d4) are all threatening the black Pawn on f5. If White plays 1 Rxf5, that would be an unsafe capture because Black will play 1 Bxf5, which is an excellent move. If, for the second move, White plays 2 Rxf5, Black will have to play 2... Rxf5. For the third move, White will play 3 Nxf5. If you calculate the material gains made by the two players, you will see that White lost ten points and gained nine, leaving him with a net loss of one. Now, let's assume that for his first move, White plays 1 Nxf5; that would be an excellent move because White used his piece of lowest value for the capture. If Black plays 1 Bxf5, White will play 2 Rxf5, then Black will play 2 Rxf5. Then for his third move, White will play 3 Rxf5. Materially, White gains nine points and losses only 8 points, leaving him with a net profit of one point. Notice that White used the same number of attackers for the two possible scenarios in the above example. Yet, in one scenario, he lost one point, and in another scenario, he

gained one point. The only thing that made a difference was the piece that White used in the first capture.

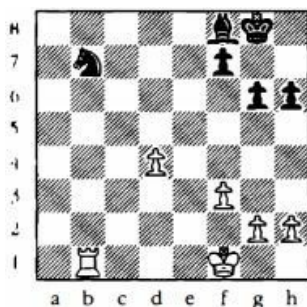
How to Deal with Threats to Pieces

As stated at the beginning of this chapter, your major aim when playing Chess should be to capture as many of your opponent's pieces as possible while defending your own pieces against attacks. Also, when capturing your opponent's pieces, you have to do it safely, so you don't end up losing more points than you gain. Just like there are ways of delivering a safety check and getting out of a check situation, there are various ways of defending your Chess pieces from attacks. When your piece is at the receiving end of an attack, here are some of the ways you can deal with the onslaught:

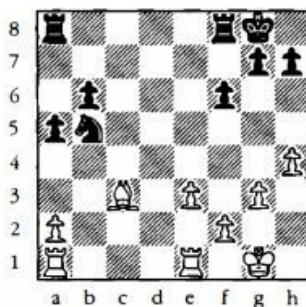
- Move the threatened piece to a safe square.
- Protect the threatened piece.
- Capture the attacking piece.
- Perform a counterattack.
- Use another piece to block the line of attack or fire.

In the next couple of pages, we will examine how to execute each of the above defense mechanisms. Note: we just listed a few ways of protecting your piece from attack; it is important to mention that there are more possibilities when it comes to defending an attacked piece.

Moving the Threatened Piece



The knight is attacked



The bishop is attacked

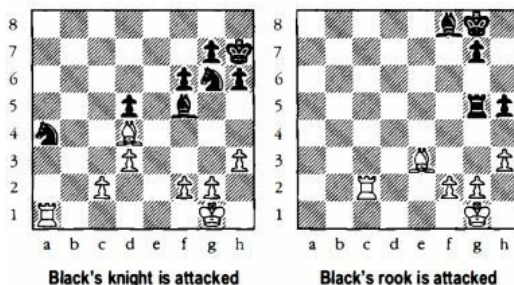
For beginners and expert players alike, moving a threatened piece is one of the easiest ways to protect or defend such a piece. In the first diagram shown above, Black's Knight on b7 is threatened by White's Rook on b1.

Black can decide to deal with this threat by simply playing 1 Na5, 1 Nd6, or 1 Nd8.

However, all these are safe moves if Black plays 1 Nc5; that would be an unsafe move because White's Pawn on d4 will simply attack it.

In the second diagram, you will see that White's Bishop on c3 is being threatened by Black's Knight on b5. If 1 Bb2, 1 Bd2, or 1 Bd4, those would-be safe moves. But if White plays 1 Be5, 1 Bb4, 1 Bf6, or 1 Bxa5, those would-be unsafe moves.

Protecting the Threatened Piece

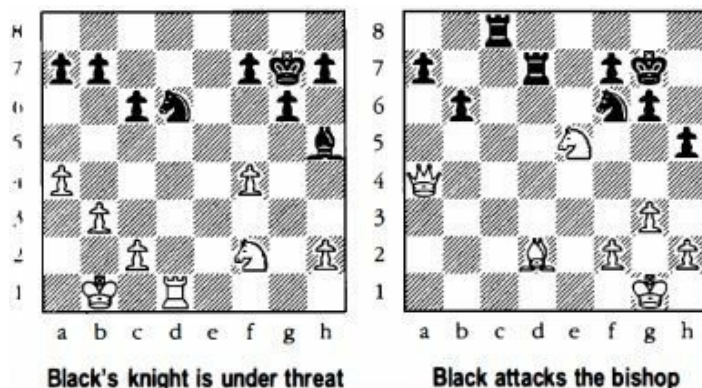


Another way to defend your threatened piece is to protect it from attack. In the first diagram above, Black's Knight on a4 is being threatened by White's Rook on a1. Notice that there are no safe squares for the black Knight to go. If the Knight moves to c5, he will still be threatened by the white Bishop on d5. I will leave you to figure out why the black Knight will not be safe in any of the other available squares.

Instead of moving his Knight, Black can deal with the attack by playing 1 Bd7, which is an excellent move. This move protects the threatened Knight on a4. If White makes a second move by playing 2 Rxa4, Black will retaliate by playing 2 Bxa4. This would result in a net gain of two points for Black (figure it out yourself).

In the second diagram, White's Bishop on e3 is threatening Black's Rook on g5. What are the possible ways that Black can protect himself from this attack? Note, the piece threatening the black Rook is a lesser piece. So, if Black plays 1... Be7, that wouldn't be considered a wise move. The reason is that if White makes a second move by playing 2 Bxg5, and Black plays 2 Bxg5, materially speaking, Black has lost two points. Instead of losing points, it would be better for Black to play 1 Rf5.

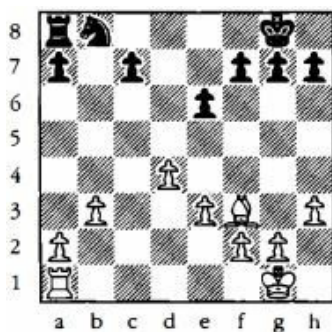
Capturing the Attacking Piece



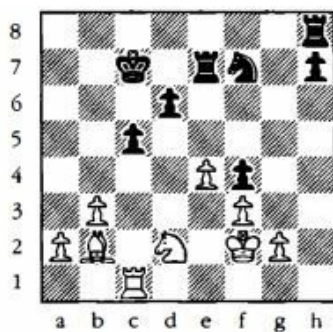
You can also use one of your free pieces to capture an attacking piece as a way of protecting your threatened piece. In the first diagram shown above, Black's Knight on d6 is being attacked by the white Rook on d1. A good way for Black to ward off this attack would be to play 1 Bxd1. White would retaliate by playing 2 Nxd1. At the end of the two transactions, Black would have made a gain of two points.

In the second diagram, Black's Rook on d7 attacks White's Bishop on d2. White can protect his Bishop from this attack by playing 1 Nxd7; then Black would play 1 Nxd7. For his second move, White would play 2 Qxd7. When you look at the two transactions in terms of material gain, you will observe that White gained five points from the transaction.

Blocking the Attack



The black rook is stuck



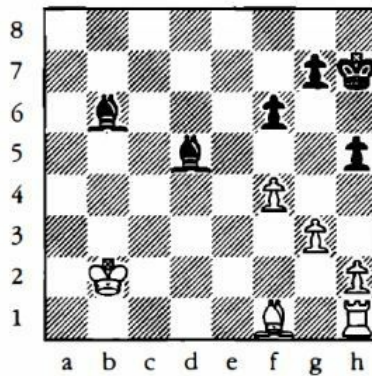
Which way to block?

Another viable way of protecting or defending a threatened piece is to block the line of fire or attack. In the first diagram shown above, the White Bishop on f3 is attacking the Black's Rook on a5. How can Black block this attack? Notice that the black Rook is in such a tight corner; it cannot move or counter the attack.

Black can protect the Rook by playing 1... c6. If White makes a second move and foolishly captures the c6-Pawn (2 Bxc6), Black would simply play 2 Nxc6, thus making White lose two points. Note that if Black plays 1 Nc6, that would be an unsafe way of blocking because White would make a second move by playing 2 Bxc6, making Black lose some points.

In the second diagram, White's Bishop on b3 attacks Black's Rook on h8. Black can block the attack by moving his Rook to another safe square on the eighth rank. Black can also play 1 Ne5, which is a safe move.

Counter-Attacking



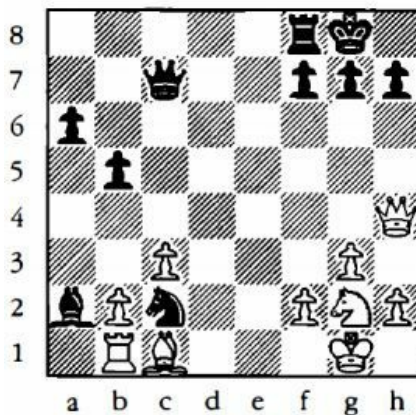
What does White do?

If you cannot safely use any of the other methods described above to protect your threatened piece, you can resort to counter-attacking your opponent's piece.

In the diagram above, Black's Bishop on d5 attacks White's Rook on h1. White's Rook that is being attacked cannot move to another safe square, there are also no other available White pieces to protect the Rook, and the attacking piece cannot be captured. White cannot also block the attack. The best thing for White to do in this case would be to play 1 Bd3+! This is an excellent move because White's threat is more serious; Black must get his King out of check.

If Black replies by playing 1 Kg8, the white Rook that was previously attacked will find some free squares and escape.

Another Way to Counter-Attack

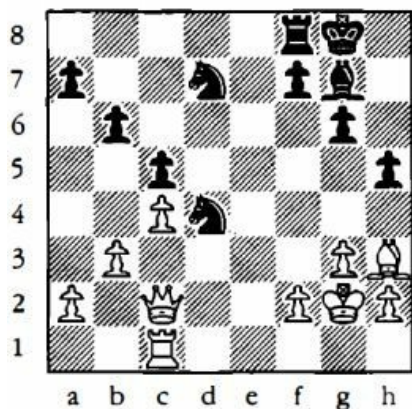


White's rook seems trapped

In the above diagram, the black Bishop on a2 attacks the white Rook on b2. As you can see, there is no escape route for the white Rook. So, White must find a way of countering the attack.

If White plays 1 Bf4+! That would be excellent because White has issued a more potent threat than Black. Black must find a way to protect his Queen because a Queen is obviously worth more than a Rook. If Black plays 1 Qc6, it means White now has enough space to move his Rook out of the tight corner.

Two Questions to Ask Before Capturing a Piece



White to play

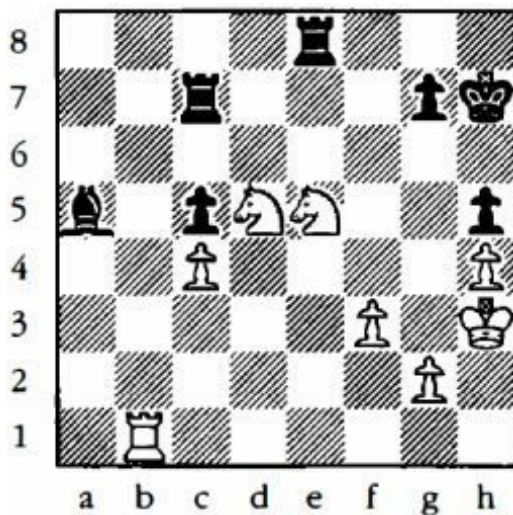
Whenever you are playing Chess, two essential questions that you should always bear in mind are:

1. Which pieces can I capture?
2. Does my opponent have any threats?

In the above diagram, it is the turn of White to play, and we can easily see that White can capture the black Knight on d7.

In the second question, you can see that White's Queen on c2 is being threatened by Black's Knight on d4. Now, if White can capture Black's threatened piece and allow Black to capture his Queen, that wouldn't be a good move because White will get three points in the transaction. So, a better way for White to deal with Black, in this case, would be to deal with Black's threat and move his Queen.

Another Scenario



White to play

In the diagram above, let's assume that it is White's turn to play. You can see that White can capture the black Rook on c7—that perfectly answers the first question that everyone should ask when playing Chess.

Now, for the second question, which is, are there any threats? The answer to that is yes. White is facing some threats. Black's Rook on e8 is threatening White's Knight on e5. If White carries out his attack and allows Black to do the same, White will still gain at the end of the transaction. Let's see. If White plays 1 Nxc7 and Black plays 1 Rxe5, White will gain two points in the transaction.

How to Defend by the Opponent and How to Counter-Attack Him

What can you do to improve your game of Chess? There are many opinions on this issue, but the only thing you can do to improve is to practice continuously. Have you ever tried to improve Chess and found it difficult and abandoned? Don't worry, a lot of people have done it, and for those who like Chess, they have spent their entire lifetime trying to make it easier! In theory, improving Chess is simply a case of learning to find the best move to play for each player in each position. The player who makes the least right moves appears to lose.

Only this model, however, is flawed. You need to think about Chess and look ahead. In some instances, the best move in that position will not be the right one until at least 2 or 3 more movements from the opponent. It means that for any position, once you determine the likely best move for that position, you will find 2 or 3 moves, at least, ahead of your opponent's best move. This is where the estimate is getting harder.

Even to start with, you need to be able to assess and analyze each position for strengths and weaknesses and the rate of which side is better or whether there is equality. When this assessment is not correct, the next step's estimates and considerations will not be correct either! In making a good decision, you need to understand Chess's essence, which involves Chess concepts, tactical, positional, and strategic variables of Chess.

Many of these fields that make up the game of Chess can be learned through play and guidance from other Chess players and video books and Chess courses. When a player knows the fundamentals of these areas and plays regularly, the importance of the three distinct phases of the Chess game, the beginning, the middle, and the end games, becomes evident. Each of the Chess factors mentioned above applies in every step of the game. Every

phase of the game, however, has special considerations.

In the opening, the goal is to build all the pieces with attention to the protection of the King with the casting and also with an emphasis on the control of the center of the board. Throughout the middle game, players strengthen the position of their Pawns and pieces and also seek to weaken the opponent's position (by capturing Pawns or pieces and making right parts trades, and creating weakened Pawn structures).

At the end of the game, the King's operation becomes significant along with the achievement of Pawn promotion and the transfer of Pawns to promote. Checkmate trends are increasingly important to learn and understand. The end game will end with a checkmate but watch out for stalemate if you play. If you lose, you may want to play to get stalemate and draw.

However, it is vital to see the Chess game as a whole, preferably consisting of all three pieces. Moves and strategies, and techniques made in the beginning have a significant impact on the middle and the end games, and it is necessary to prepare ahead, to account for this. A longer-term strategy may reverse short-term benefits (e.g., the exchange of a Bishop for the capture of a Knight, perhaps a wrong decision depending on the type of game, open, semi-open or closed, which results) with further advantages.

Chess has always been a very competitive sport, even before the first World Chess Championship in 1886. People have always considered Chess champions to be great thinkers who still drive the game to higher heights every time they play the game. As everyone may find out, most people who strive to become a Chess grandmaster don't have the luxury of playing Chess early. But it's that kind of thought that offers a lame reason not to do one's best at all. Just note that nothing is impossible with the human mind. There's always a way where there's a will. To defeat opponents who have been at the game for decades and have proved to be Chess experts, one first needs a great deal of self-confidence. In reality, self-esteem is the cornerstone upon which all else is founded. If you don't think you can do that, you're not going to prove yourself wrong. Official Chess tournaments also use the Chess clock to ensure that the tournament starts at the scheduled

time. Most people still make the mistake of taking too much time to plan their early game plans and defenses, and as a catastrophic result can appear.

First, only by playing it and playing it often can you get better at Chess. The more you play Chess, the more you will understand the connection between the pieces, and the more you will be able to manipulate them to make some smart moves. Playing regularly, particularly with a variety of opponents, can teach you several different approaches to the game. You'll begin to be able to understand how your opponents think and to be able to recognize the moves they're preparing based on the moves they're making. Being able to see the future of Chess is one of the best attributes any player can have, so when you know what your opponent is going to do, you can create a strategy around it and combat it effectively.

Learning all about Chess in your spare time can also go a long way to preparing you to play a competitive game. There are a variety of books available that concentrate on every aspect of the game. You will learn how to play a powerful opening, set yourself up to conquer the board. You might read a book all about the endgame; learn how to make the best use of all the pieces left so you can win a checkmate yourself. Some pieces concentrate only on unique and popular moves that have been performed in various games, each with its name and history.

There are several places available that give you a new Chess move of the day and present you with a Chess problem to solve. Such issues will provide you with an example of a Chessboard and all the pieces on it, showing you that a checkmate or a capture of a particular piece is possible within a specified number of moves. It's your job, then, to try and find out what those moves are to solve the problem.

Chess is a challenging game, indeed, but it can be learned. Being a good Chess player can be a great asset, both because it's impressive and because it can make you start looking at the world differently. This can give you a new outlook on how to solve problems, which can be invaluable in the end.

When you have developed a reliable baseline technique, you need to know how to identify dangerous conditions and potentially beneficial movements. You need to know how to make the most of your adversary while not succumbing to him. There are some simple traps and techniques that you need to be aware of to defend against as well as seek to use in a Chess game. Don't be afraid to try a new trap and learn from your mistakes.

Error Management

Carelessness can bring undesirable results. This is the same with Chess. Some players don't lose because they lack the skill. Rather, they are not very careful with their moves and end up doing something disadvantageous for them. This can eventually cost them the game. Here are the three common accidents in Chess that every Chess player should be aware of. Knowing these will allow them to spot possible scenarios that will lead to it and eventually avoid it.

Losing Your Piece for Nothing

Capturing one of your opponent's pieces (or having one of yours captured) is a normal part of the game. It is common for players to bait their opponent to capture one of their pieces because another piece is guarding that square in case it is captured. If you should lose a piece, the opponent should also lose one of theirs. However, it can be costly for a player to lose any piece but don't get anything in return. This situation can be treated as if they gave something to the opponent for free. Here is an example:



In the image above, it can be seen that White moved his Knight to f7 and threaten Black's Queen and Rook. However, what White fails to notice is that Black's King guards the square where it landed. Since the Knight is not guarded by any other piece in case of capture, Black can capture the Knight for free!



Sometimes, hanging pieces are not that obvious. The image below appears like a normal opening sequence for the game. However, if one is to look closely, White can capture Black's Rook on the other corner of the board. Free 5 points for White! Even if Black decides to block the Bishop, it will surely be able to capture another piece before getting captured.

A player should look at all areas carefully so that having a “hanging” piece can be avoided. Obviously, this is a mistake that you want your enemies to commit, as it can give you an advantage.

Losing a Piece with Higher Value

It was mentioned earlier that having one of your pieces captured for free is bad. This opens the idea that you should at least get something in exchange for that piece. However, this doesn't mean that we should settle for pieces that have a lower value. Capturing an opponent's piece with a lower value than ours is not good either.

Suppose the game drags on, and this trend of getting an “uneven trade” continues. In that case, the player whose higher value pieces are traded for lower value ones will end up with a deficit and eventually lose the game because their power is significantly reduced.



The image above shows that White took out his Queen way too early. Black responded by moving his Pawn to d5 and opening the Bishop for capture. If White decides to take on the bait, his Queen will be easily captured even if Black's Bishop has been sacrificed. By simply referring back to the point value of pieces, it can be seen that White will lose 9 points while Black will only lose 3.

Players should remember that even though capturing multiple pieces can help them get an advantage, being able to target and capture high-value pieces is still better. Trades should be based on the value of the piece, not on how many can be captured in exchange for a high-value piece. Even if you are able to capture three Pawns, it would still be an uneven trade if your Queen or Rook gets captured because of those small pieces.

Your Pieces Are Outnumbered

It is common for a player to offer one of his pieces as bait so that he can capture anything that attempts to capture that piece, especially if a piece with a higher value will be involved. However, there are times when a piece is not guarded enough. If the opponent sees an area that does not have enough protection, he will surely exploit that weakness. He may even be willing to sacrifice some of his lower value pieces just so he can capture your higher value pieces. In this case, it's important to defend possible weak areas more. By doing this, your opponent will hesitate in capturing one of your pieces.



The image above is an example of the four-move tactic that can win games for White. This tactic exploits the weakness of the Pawn in f7. With White to move, it can be seen that the said Pawn is only protected by Black's King. However, that same piece is threatened by White's Bishop and Queen. Since the defense for that area is not sufficient, White can capture that area without any problems, get protected by the Bishop, and checkmate the opponent.

Play Chess Online, Competitions and ELO Level Player

When you buy a wooden Chess set or an electronic Chess set, you buy a fundamental piece of culture, history, and mental stimulation. But if you play traditional wooden Chess or against another human or electronic Chess against artificial intelligence, you must know some of the essential elements of Chess strategy. If you get into this beautiful game for yourself, the same thing will happen to you. This strategy is particularly crucial for Chess. It's not a game that can be improvised (at least not wholly), and if you really want to win, you can't just rely on luck. Each improvisation in Chess should be the result of only responding to the opponent's movements. Before you start the game, you want to have a mapping strategy.

On the off chance that you are a Chess learner, you will build up your playing style after some time; however, that doesn't imply that you have delivered the absolute most fundamental Chess techniques created more than several years and demonstrated to work. How about we investigate the absolute most fundamental Chess procedures you can begin taking a shot at immediately.

- Use your pedestrians a lot. Do not just use them as sacrifices, and do not try to keep them away. Keep your opponent's power plays threatened or "trapped" using wise steps. At the same time, you brutally take your opponent's infantry; don't say, "Oh, it's just infantry." Make it a point to delete them.
- Use your Knights very early in the game - you may even want to create a trap in which your first move uses a Knight instead of a pedestrian.
- The castle as quickly as time permits in the game.
- Some Chess masters say that a Bishop must never capture you to catch a Knight. Others say that the Bishop should capture a Knight whenever possible, even if it means that

the Bishop will succeed with the next move. Take a look at both of these ideas and see which one of them works better for you as your style progresses.

- Always try to adjust the items so that your opponent pays for the recording of one of your tracks. The cost for him should be high. I.E., if your opponent catches you, Rookie, set him to immediately capture one of his power pieces, such as the Bishop, Knight, or Rook (or Queen, if possible). Don't let one of your pieces get caught when you turn your entire opponent into one.
- As an unwritten rule, the best piece used to try to surprise the opponent's Queen is a Knight. Never sacrifice your Queen unless you reach the Queen. Never sacrifice the Queen of your opponent - never renounce any of your pieces, except your Queen.
- Attack your opponent, but you can only make some moves that you think about in the first place. Be forceful yet show restraint. The anxiety in Chess is a snare of death.
- As a rule, the ideal approach to utilize your snares is to adjust them vertically. For instance, I.E., One is on the back street at D2, and the other at D6 simultaneously.

How Can You Play Better Chess?

Some say you should study the tactic and spend more than 50 percent of your study time. Others recommend using the options that maximize your performance—some things that will make you undergo comfortability. Some coaches and coaches recommend that you read your favorite grandma's games. And we are just reaching the tip of the iceberg!

Undoubtedly, these experimental methods of studying Chess will equip you with more knowledge about the game - they will give you more ideas and plans, enrich your tactical vision, and so on. To win the next game, you play hard. However, onboard Chess, it seems like all those great ideas are flying out the window when it comes to real-world games! You don't realize how to apply them in your games! If this sounds like it (and probably does), you'll probably love the following two tips and tricks to teach you how to play better Chess!

Game Better 1: Take Your Time!

Yes, good people, try and pay attention to this at first. You have to be more discriminating with the help you give to other people. After all, Chess is the game of a thinking man. It's not about the speed of your hands, and it's not about how fast you move or hit the clock. All this makes you think you're good at a game. All this goes well with how you can deal with the problems you face and how well you challenge the man on the board—the opponent.

And maybe you don't have time to evaluate your situation; you can say that you think well during the game. Even world-class players need hours to complete a Chess game—Carlsen, Anand, Topal—Their matches last from two to four hours. Sometimes even 7 hours of play in the London Classic 2010 (which I think is Cremenik-Carlsen).

If they recognize that they have to spend time thinking and evaluating the situation in front of them, why not do the same? Whether you play Chess online, on the board, or a combination of both, get used to your time, especially in urgent situations, which you need to develop.

Game Better 2: Your Opponent Has the Same Word in the Game!

Some Chess players, those who are already logical, can apply the first tip. But chances are, they lose in the second case: consider the threats and opportunities of the opponent! Don't just look at the ideas and opportunities available to you, but also consider what the other person has. Ignoring this point, the main reason why amateurs do not mix is the fact that the King puts on a simple pairing combination, allowing forks and other objects.

Your thinking process should be sufficient to shield all of your fundamentals; be aware of the possibilities available to your rival and yourself at the same time! These strategic tips work on any Chess set! Anything else does not matter; only mentality!

Workbook on Chess Tactics Problems and Get-Out for the Most Common Situations

First, let's talk about what tactics are in Chess. A tactic can be described as a tool that you can use to accomplish certain goals. Using these tools effectively is what makes for a strong level of play in Chess. Being able to spot tactics, and defend against them when used by your opponent, is critical in becoming a better Chess player.

Piece Evaluation

Just in case you didn't already know, let's cover the standard values of the pieces, which is helpful in determining how some tactics are actually effective.

- Pawns are usually worth 1 point.
- Knights are usually worth about 3 points.
- Bishops are usually worth about 3 points.
- Rooks are usually worth about 5 points.
- And a Queen is usually worth about 9 points.

If you were curious about why the pieces are usually worth a certain amount instead of always being worth that much, let us consider the most extreme case, the lowly Pawn. A white Pawn on its starting rank, 2, is worth 1 point for sure. But a passed Pawn on the 5th or 6th rank will be worth close to 3 points because it needs to have a piece watch over it to stop it from promoting. A Pawn on the 7th rank is worth nearly as much as a Queen, as it is so close to promotion, maybe 8 points.

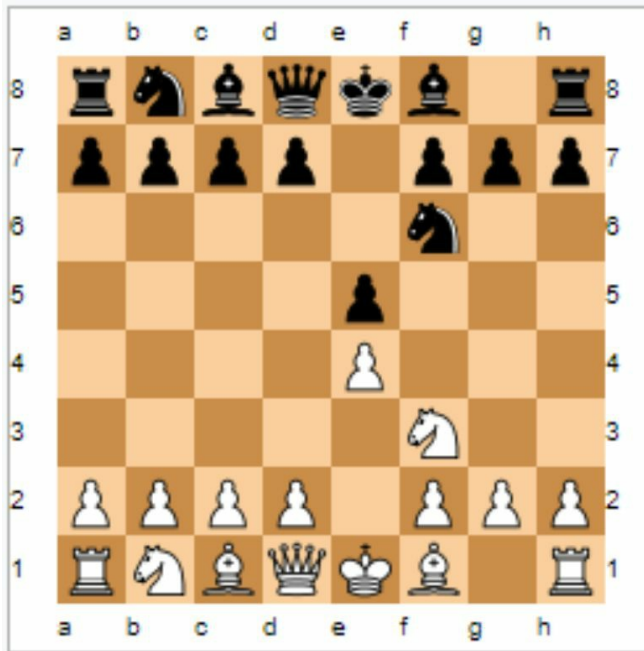
These points don't add up to win you the game in a literal sense, but they help a Chess player understand which player is ahead when evaluating the position, as we will cover later on. For now, just understand the basic values, and any special circumstances we visit in this book will be covered and explained. Now let's start with the most basic tactic, a pin.

Pins

A pin happens whenever an attacking piece leaves a defending piece in a situation where it would expose another valuable piece behind to attack if it were to move. (Typically, a King or Queen). Let's take a look at an example:



Now, I understand there is a whole lot going on in this picture so let's focus our attention on just the black Bishop on g4, the white Knight on f3, and the white Rook on d1. The black Bishop is pinning the white Knight against the Rook because if the Knight were to move, say to e5, it would expose the Rook to an attack from the black Bishop. When it comes to pinned pieces, there is a general rule that is good to know and follow.



That rule is: attack the pinned piece. Since the pinned piece can't move, we are sure to win in any ensuing exchange. Unfortunately, for Black in our example, they don't have a good option to attack the pinned Knight at this moment.

Pins can happen at all stages of the game; as you see in this example, all black has to do is play 3 D6 and 4 Bg4, and already, we have reached a pin with the black Bishop pinning the White Knight to the Queen. Even if white alleviates the pin with a move like Be2, the pin is still effective by forcing White to develop their piece into a less ideal square (instead of saying c4).

During your own Chess matches, be sure to watch out for opportunities to use this tactic for yourself and think ahead if you sense that your opponent might be trying to use this tactic on you. Look for ways to play proactively against these types of situations by slightly altering your move order, but still aiming to accomplish the same overall structure or game plan. Next up, let's take a look at forks.

Forks

A fork happens when an attacking piece attacks two or more pieces simultaneously. Interestingly, any piece can deliver a fork in Chess, including Pawns and the King! Let's take a look at a particular case now:



This is the Knight's specialty. The Knight just loves to hunt for royalty and finds the mark hereafter Ne2+ forking the King and Queen. After White is forced to play Kh1 , the Queen is cut down with Nxg3+ . Notice how in this example, the Pawn on h2 is actually pinned to the King and cannot recapture the Knight on g3! If instead, White foolishly recaptures with fxg3 , then Black wins immediately with $\text{Rxf1\#}$.



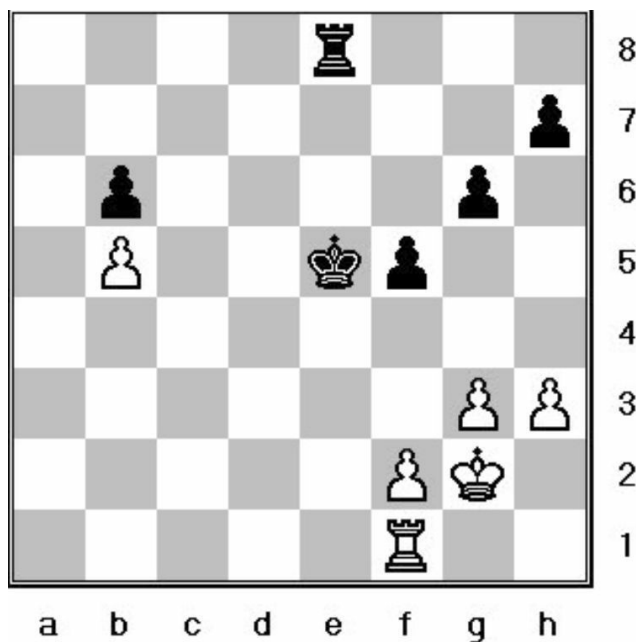
In this next example, the fork was delivered by a lowly Pawn and to great effect! Black is forced to move the King to h5, and white captures the Rook with hxf6. When planning your next move, look out for these maneuvers and try to think creatively. Sometimes, you can lure your opponent into forks by trying to force a piece to move to a certain square where a fork is possible. This is one of the creative parts of Chess, where you have to learn to make opportunities happen.

If you get caught in a particularly nasty fork, learn from it. I mean, literally, learn from it. Look at what your opponent did to place you in a position for a fork and how they managed to mask their intentions. Chess is a mind game and a board game, and learning these subtle nuances can help you read the table better in the future. Next, let's look at Skewers, and I am not referring to Shish kebab.

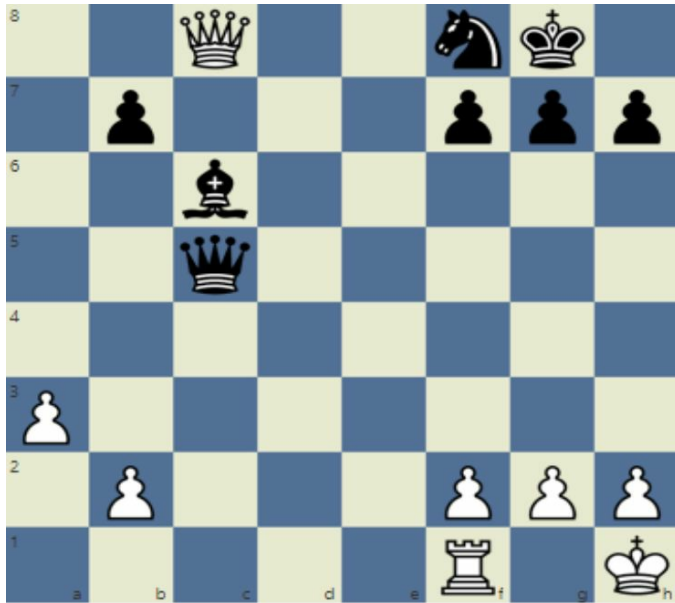
Skewers

In Chess, a skewer is very similar to a pin, except the high-value target is the one being attacked, and when it moves, it exposes a vulnerable target behind it. One of the reasons why a skewer is named a distinct tactic, instead of being lumped in together with

pins, is that a skewer tends to have more impact, as the high-value target has little choice to move and expose the vulnerable target behind. Let's take a look at an example now.

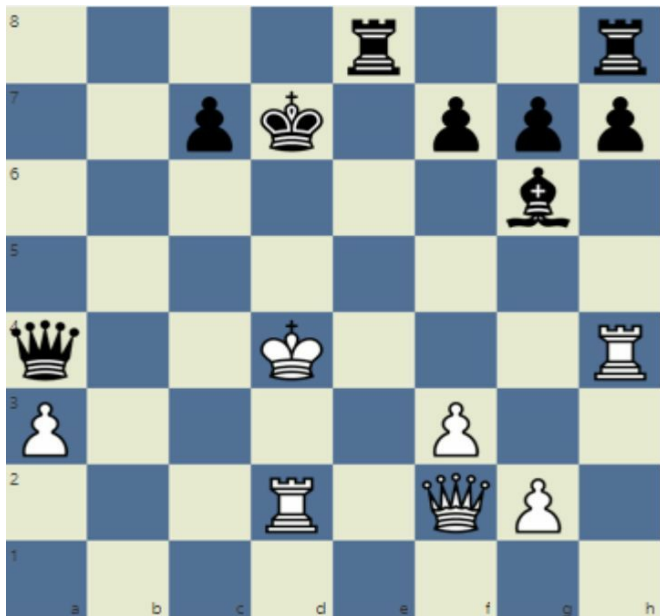


In the example on the right, white can deliver a skewer with the move Re1. The Rook is attacking black's King, and when he moves to any legal square, the black Rook on e8 is exposed, and white captures it. A skewer has a similar tactical feel to pins, but with a few key differences to note. First, a skewer is more forceful than a pin since you are attacking a high-value target with a lesser value piece. Secondly, skewers tend to be a more common tactic in the late game. Rooks are really great at delivering skewers, and they tend to work best with a lot of open space, like the endgame.



Taking a look at our first example, Black making a move, we notice a relationship between the two Queens and Black's Bishop on the c file. The White Queen is not protected, and we control the only piece blocking it from being attacked by our own Queen.

Black can use this fact to win a piece after Bxg2+! White is in check and has to move, so it will capture on g2, Kxg2, and black wins will win very easily after the next move Qxc8 winning Queen for a Bishop. Let's take a look at another example:



Here, it looks for a moment like White's King is caught in the crossfire between a Rook and a Queen but can turn this game on its head after a spectacular double discovered attack with the move Kc3+!! Suddenly, it is both of Black's royalty that comes under siege after this stunning move. Black plays Ke7 trying to get to safety. Now, what should White play next?

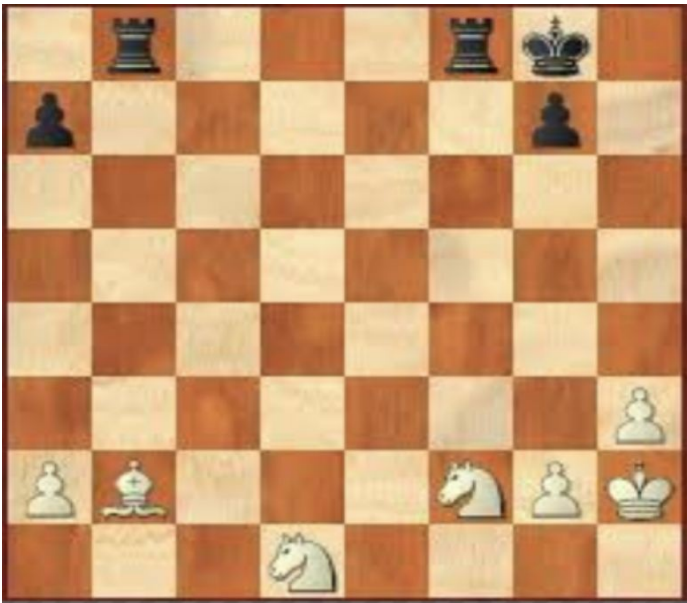
If you said Rxa4, while that is a really good move, it isn't the best move. White should play Qc5+ first, drawing the King further out into the open. Black is forced to play Kf6, now running into the middle of the board, never a good sign. And this would be the appropriate time to play Rxa4, winning the Queen.

While White certainly could have won had they played Rxa4 right away, the King is in a much more precarious position because of a little patience to play the best possible move. Next up is 'Overloading the Defender,' a mouthful but very useful!

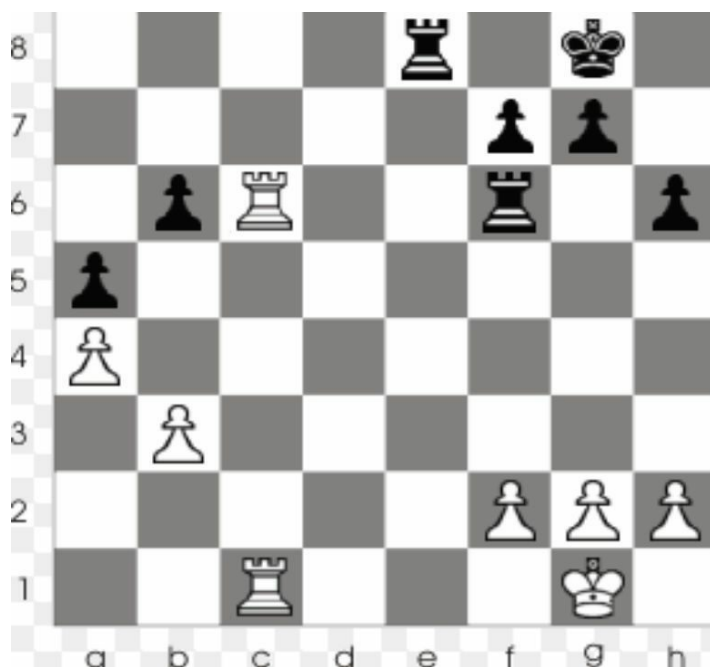
Overloading the Defender

This tactic can also go by the name 'Deflection,' or overworking the defender, but both these names are used interchangeably. If one piece is trying to do more than one job, it is overloaded. You can take advantage of this by forcing the overloaded piece into making

a move to defend one of its posts and leaving the other open to attack. Let's take a look at an example:



In this position, while the white Knight on d1 does cover both the white Bishop and the other white Knight, but importantly, it can't cover them both at the same time. Black can take advantage of the fact that white has overloaded their Knight with $Rxf2$, $Nxf2$, $Rxb2$, and black has won two pieces for a Rook. Black could have taken the other piece, and they would have ended up with a similar position, and either way, a Rook is a lot better than a Bishop or a Knight in the late game. The second example is a bit of a different one!



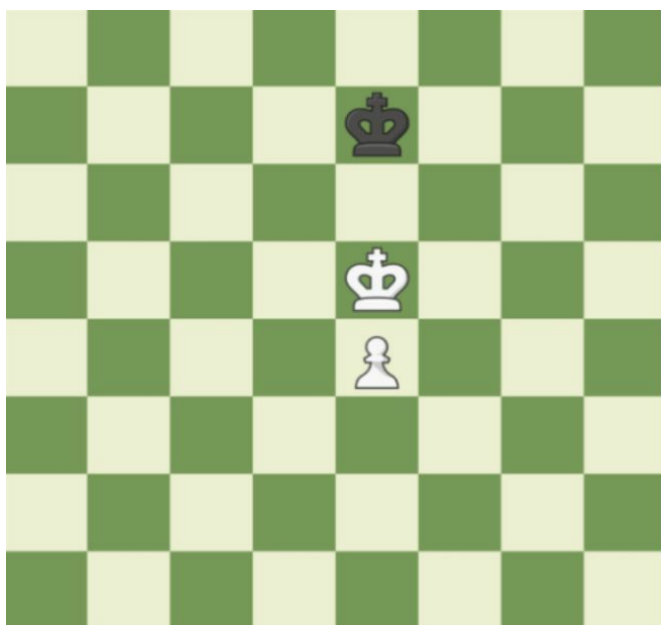
The overloaded piece in this example is the Rook on c1. Can you see why? The Rook is obviously protecting its buddy on c6, the other white Rook, but did you notice that the Rook is also guarding the e1 square? This one is a bit trickier, so if you didn't get it, that's okay. See, if black plays $Rxc6$ and white decides to recapture with $Rxc6$, black has the winning move $Re1\#$. Black is caught in a back-rank mate.

This pattern of three Pawns and a King being mated on the last rank is very common and can be done by Rooks or a Queen; it's called a back-rank mate. Next, we will take a look at 'Zugzwang.'

No, I didn't just sneeze; it's a real word. Let's take a look!

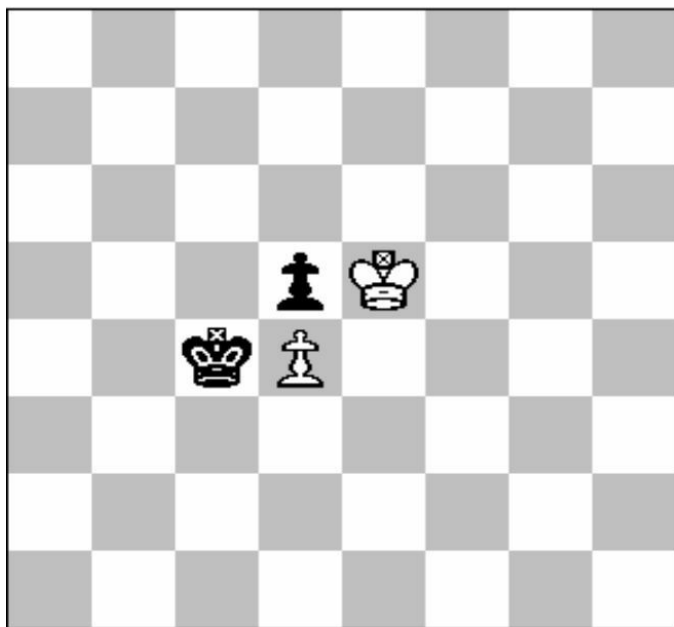
Zugzwang

Zugzwang is probably not going to be a word familiar to you unless you're German. It means "compulsion to move." The concept is that there can arise moments in Chess where if a player were to move, it would be detrimental to their position. Unfortunately for that player, the rules of Chess do not allow you to pass your turn simply. You must move a piece, even if doing so would be detrimental to you. If you legally cannot move, the game is instead a stalemate or a draw. This situation happens very often in the King and Pawn vs. King end-game situation. Let's take a look at an example:



Here if Black were to make a move, they are in zugzwang, because they will no longer be able to take the opposition from White. We will cover what that means in detail, but for now, know that to draw a game from these kinds of positions, the defending King needs to stay in line with the attacking King. For example, if it were White playing, White could move to either side, and Black could keep the opposition, and the game would be a draw. The endgame is a whole other area for you to study to master your

Chess game, and too extensive to cover in any significant detail here.

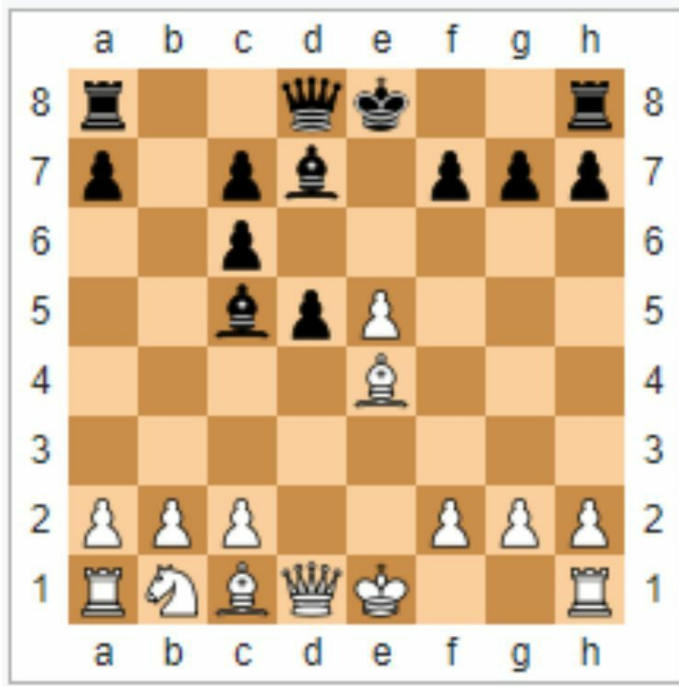


In this second example, it doesn't actually matter whose turn it is; both players are in mutual zugzwang. If it's Black that will play, they're forced to abandon their Pawn, and White will go on to win easily or vice versa if White were to play instead.

Setting up these positions on purpose can be quite difficult in practice, except in the case of the endgame, as mentioned. Do keep an eye out, though, as this can arise in other moments as well, and recognizing a moment to impose zugzwang is a sure way to gain an advantage in your games. Next up another German word, 'Zwischenzug,' which means 'Intermediate Move,' and we don't mean skill level.

Zwischenzug

This is definitely a high-level tactic, as it requires great vision and depth in your situational awareness. Zwischenzug happens when instead of the expected move (typically a recapture during an exchange), and in-between move is played instead that alters the exchange in some way, usually to their benefit.



Let's look at an example from the incredibly famous game T. Lichtenhein v. Paul Morphy in 1857, New York. In this example, Morphy has the black pieces, and after White's last move, Bxe4 just lost his Knight. The expected move is dxe4 to complete the exchange. However, this expected exchange would weaken Black's Pawn structure significantly. Instead, Morphy plays the move Qh4!

When this move was played, it shocked the people who saw it, and it was talked about heavily in the newspapers of their day. Morphy's idea is that his Bishop is already attacking the weak f2 square for white, which is only defended by the King. After the move, Qh4 Black has added another attacker against the f2 square, which will also attack the undefended e4 Bishop. If White simply tries to save their Bishop with the move Bf3, White can win immediately with Qxf2# supported by the Bishop on c5. A brilliant move by Morphy.



Here is another example, White to move: White sees an opportunity to capture the Pawn on d5, so he or she plays the move Nxd5. Black is okay with this exchange, thinking that the exchange would continue: Qxd2, Rxd2, Nxd5, and Black would be up material, Queen and Knight, for Queen and Pawn. White, however, has other ideas. After Black's move Qxd2, white plays the unexpected zwischenzug

Nxe7+! After Black is forced to play Kh8, it is White who comes out ahead now after Rxd2, Black's Queen, Knight, and Pawn, for white's Queen. When evaluating a potential exchange, try to look at the entire board for a zwischenzug you might have missed!

What's Next?

Okay, so we just learned a whole bunch of moves for both white and black that only get us to move 5 to 10 or so. What next? How do we proceed from here when we are swimming in unknown waters? Welcome to the mid-game. These are the uncharted waters that Chess players try and navigate actually to win a game of Chess. When you reach the end of your opening knowledge, this is called playing out of the book, and there are a few key ideas to keep in mind to help guide you along your way.

Know the Endgame

This is probably the other most important area to study in Chess. Considered dry by many in the Chess community, the endgame study mostly involves rote memorization of mating patterns. While not the most exciting area of study, recognizing a winning position from 6 moves away can certainly help you get through the otherwise uncertain parts of the mid-game. If you can master an extensive list of moves in the opening, and you can recognize mating patterns from several moves away, you are chipping away at the unknown part of the game for you to have to play in. At a minimum, you should work to be able to checkmate a King on the open board with each of the possible pieces to do so. Some are as simplistic as they come, such as Queen and King. Others can prove a challenge for even a seasoned player of the game, such as a checkmate with two Bishops and a Knight, is not an easy task to be sure. The endgame study is far too broad a topic to include here in this chapter; however, so be sure to look for other resources on this topic to improve your game.

Know the Tactics

Unlike a broad and fuzzy topic like, what strategy should I use to win? Tactics are tools to know in your Chess toolbox. They are

pieces you can learn to recognize both for yourself and from your opponent. Using tactics allows you to gain an edge in position, material, or time (tempo). We have already introduced the fork, pin, and discovered attack, but let's include the full list and briefly explain the rest. The tactics to know include:

Pins		Forks
• Skewers		• Discovered Attacks
• Overloading Defender	the	• Sacrifices
• Zugzwang		• Zwischenzug

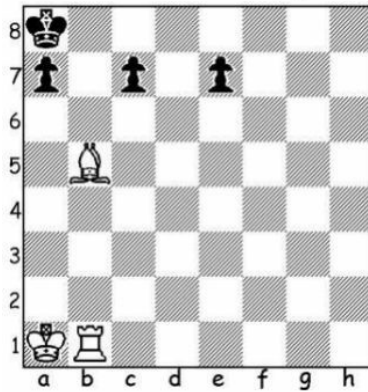
For reference, we will define these tactics here once again. Pins are when your attack on the front piece is lined up with another more valuable piece behind it, making it disadvantageous to move the pinned piece. A good general rule to follow is to attack the pinned piece. Skewers are very similar to pins, except reversed. The attack is against a high-value target such as the King or Queen, with another usually undefended piece lined up behind it. When the high-value target has to move out of the way, you attack against the piece behind. Forks are the Knight's specialty, although, in truth, any piece can deliver a fork attack. Forks occur when with one move, you attack more than one of your opponent's pieces. Usually, this can involve a check against the King while threatening some other piece that is typically lost. Discovered Attacks, we have already touched on, but they happen when the movement of a piece exposes an attack onto another piece. This is often done with a Knight moving to attack deep into enemy positions, exposing a threat from a Bishop, Rook, or Queen behind it. Overloading the Defender is a bit of a different tactic, but the essential boils down to looking for pieces that are overworked and focusing there. In an arbitrary example, if a Knight is a vital defender of, say, the e4 Pawn and is also a vital defender of a Bishop on, say, d5, that Knight is overloaded and can't protect both. You can use this to your advantage by attacking one side and having another attack prepared for the other piece after the Knight is forced to respond. Sacrifices are attacks in which the attacker will lose an attacking piece or pieces without any material as

compensation. The reason for these often flashy, reckless looking attacks is to expose an otherwise weak position to its breaking point. Sometimes by making a sacrifice attack, you can create such instability in the opponent's position that even down material as you are, they cannot possibly hope to defend against the force you can bring down on them. Some of the great immortal games of Chess are exciting sacrificial attacks such as this. Zugzwang, a German term meaning "compulsion to move," is an idea that may sometimes force your opponent to move can lead to an advantage. Especially in King and Pawn vs. King endgames, this principle often makes the difference between a win and a draw. Often in Chess, the simple concept of giving away a tempo can lead to an advantage. Zwischenzug is another German term, this time meaning "intermediate move." The principle is that sometimes in a lengthy exchange that both sides have seemingly calculated deeply, there can exist a Zwischenzug or in-between move that catches the other person completely off-guard and changes the entire dynamic of the position. This can be something obvious like a check that brings the exchange to a screeching halt, a big flashy sacrifice, or even a quiet move that just slightly alters the position in such a way that the calculation now favors the other player. Definitely, one of the subtler concepts to know, but worth covering, nonetheless.

Learn about the Principles of Chess

In the second book in this series, *Chess Openings for Beginners*, we will be focusing on strategy and tactics. One of the key strategic elements it will cover is some of the core principles of Chess. If you've played the game for any length of time, you will hear some old adages of advice such as "Knights on the rim look dim" and "Passed Pawns must be pushed." There are many more of these gems of advice to learn. More importantly than just knowing these principles, however, is understanding them and applying them to your game.

Chess Puzzles



The study of Chess can become a bit dry and tedious at times if you just stare at a Chessboard and a reference to study. One of the ways Chess players have found to improve is to create Chess puzzles and challenging each other to find a solution to a clever position.

The puzzle on the right is a very simple example of a type of puzzle called "Mate-in-One," where the puzzle asks the player to find the next move to win the game. Some puzzles are much more complex and can stump even some of the best names in Chess. The point of these puzzles is not to puff your chest and say how much you know, but to get you thinking about the game in new ways and hopefully help your brain recognize some winning positions due to being familiar with a similar position from a puzzle you've completed. They really work! And more importantly, they can keep things fun, so you don't get bored while trying to learn.

Join a Chess Club

No, seriously, join a Chess club in your area! This is a great way to meet new players and probably new friends too. Most major cities boast at least one major Chess club and cater to players of all skill ranges. They host kids' events for young children, as well as tournaments for those wishing to test their competitive mettle. The local Chess club is a fantastic resource to learn about the game and meet potential coaches and mentors willing to help you grow as a player.

Find a Mentor

Along with joining a Chess club, you can try and find a mentor, someone from a local Chess club or tournament with some experience that is willing to take you under their wing and show you some cool tricks and tips about the game. These people can offer you a literal lifetime of knowledge to draw upon and are invaluable to you as a growing player.

Play in a Local Tournament

Along with joining a Chess club, this is another great way to enter into Chess's exciting world in a big way. At a local tournament, you will meet players of all skill levels, and it is another fantastic way to make Chess friends and learn about the game. After playing a match for real in a tournament, you will find others to talk to about your matches and learn about ways you could have played differently and different ideas for next time.

Also, because you are playing several games back-to-back with time in between, it's a great way to try something, learn some new skills after your game, and apply those new skills in your very next round. Some of the biggest names in Chess history found their start in a small local tournament that grew into a passionate love for the game.

Conclusion

Chess is one of the world's oldest and most renowned games. It is supposed to have come from India since the seventh century, but the exact origin of Chess is not known. Chess has existed in several ways. Most people today play the so-called European Chess. Chess is a universal game—universal in that all countries and societies embrace and play it. Chess is universal. There are numerous worldwide tournaments and many more in each region.

Chess' basic rules are simple, but to play strategically and expert strategies take skill and commitment. The game contains an 8 to 8 board of alternating black and white squares and Chess pieces in its modern format. Each player has seventeen pieces used to play with the game. A King, eight Pawns, a Queen, and two Bishops, Knights, and Rooks are beginning. The game's goal is to corner the opponent's King and immobilize him so he can make no further moves.

Modern Chess is often called 'King' Chess, as the Queen is the most important piece. It can move several squares in any direction since there is ample room to maneuver. All pieces, except for Knights, move straight or diagonally. The Knight movements are identical to the form of the letter 'L.' if the King's piece of the opponent is immobilized; it is known as "checkmate."

Chess has many advantages, and children from an early age are still taught in many schools worldwide. It has many academic advantages and improves our skills. Chess strengthens the cognitive capacity of a child by teaching multiple skills. This requires the ability to concentrate, schedule future projects, think analytically, abstractly, and strategically, and weigh all the possibilities before moving on. They also improve one's social and communication skills with another human player. Research shows that children who play Chess often develop their math and reading skills.

Chess can now be played everywhere. What you need to do is play

the board and sections and someone. There are plenty of computerized variants of Chess if you don't find another human to challenge. The app comes in many versions, including 2D or 3D, and has lovely, animated effects or as a single board and as a single object. You can play against a computer player and upgrade the difficulty level if appropriate. With the Internet, it is now easy to scan for many other online matches.

No one from my study enjoys most Chess games. For those who like Chess, this game is full of mental strength, and much of the strategy is required, but for the normal ignorant and the Fun Chess fanatics, Chess can be considered a boring thing. Tactics and mental preparation are part of an enjoyable Chess game. Chess exercises our minds. Much like what they say, it's the battle of the players' minds during a Chess match!

They find it incredibly fun and thrilling to the regular game lovers. However, some players are doing another thing, which is collecting Chess pieces. I know it may sound dull, but it isn't. A true object of the collector is difficult to locate. For example, a popular Chess set of Mickey Mouse can be found in malls, but the 12k silver Chess set of 1954 is not.

The strange thing about Chess is how the game rules have been the same for hundreds of years. While with those few hundred years, the Chess pieces' looks have changed, the rules are not affected. Therefore, some people want to collect Chess sets since a certain object can be used much better because of its antiquity.

These antique pianos are a good example of antiques with unaffordable prices. Over the years, they appear to be more costly. Another thing you can do with these Chess pieces is to pass them to your grandsons. Due to today's modern technology, most Chess sets were modeled on recent and renowned films, figures, and drawings. Are you aware that there's a Winnie the Pooh Chess set already? It's no joke.

This can also attract your little siblings/cousins' children to play Chess. Just imagine playing a Chess game with your favorite Chess set, maybe Star Wars. Imagine how good it would be to eat the villagers and vice versa. This gives the game a whole new level of

excitement. The bottom line is that Chess has been played for numerous years. It was passed down through generations. I need to accept that the same Chess rules could be very boring, so why not introduce an entirely new level of excitement to your Chess game?

CHESS OPENINGS FOR BEGINNERS

*Find Out the Most Important Openings
and How to Counter-attack the
Opponent Ones Develop Correctly
Your Pieces and Predict Each Move*

By
Bobby Myers

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CONCLUSION

Introduction

Chess is a famous table recreation around the world. While many people are satisfied to play Chess on an everyday plastic board, many players who love the sport are happy with their precise Chess sets. Before we get into what Chess is about and how it plays out, let's speak a little bit about its records.

The records of the Chess term have been in life for quite a long time. Chess began from the start. Over the years, it has to turn out to be a complex recreation wherein many competitions spend productive time. It has said Chess was created in India. Chaturanga, the ancient game, turned into played around the 6th century in northwestern India. These 4 gadgets represented 4 different sorts of military devices. The corporations had been infantry, elephants, cavalry, and chariots.

The cavalry mimics the knight's play and turns into a unique feature that hyperlinks the historical recreation of Chaturanga with modern Chess. The automobile changed into a Rook piece, and it moved like a Rook. The sport additionally had a spell and a mantra. Pawn represented and acted as a royal piece, a mantra (counselor or general) which served the Queen piece and transferred a square diagonally.

Chess was inaugurated to Europeans around a thousand AD. At that time, the Queen, named Vizier, had the simplest movement of Kings. The Queen was not able to move except with the gap in it. The Queen would turn out to be the most important piece, and Chess is known as the "Queen's Chess."

The current Chess commenced in 1500. A fundamental exchange had taken place. The Queen had spread out her cutting-edge ability to move overboard, as she does now. Theories and regulations appear, and Chess recreation had begun to move toward today's performance. Aristocracy started to get concerned about Chess as a sport. It has become widespread because of the exchange in Chess.

Around 1800, it had become obtrusive that new forms of Chess sets

had been needed. The Chess parts were very similar, and it became tough to distinguish them. Charles Cook and John Jacques from London created the primary set of Staunton Chess. Cook is thought to have invented new snapshots and named the collection the first-class Chess player of that time, Richard Stanton. The Knight acquired the horse's head recognized. Rook looked at a castle. The bishop's frame has ended up a fixed form of the bishop. The Queen and King received the crown at that point.

Although it's miles unclear where the form of the modern-day Pioneer piece got here from, it's far feasible to resort to John Jacques's effort to layout it without problems and, even though it has been assumed that the base and compass of the Freemason are inspired. The Freemasons of that time represented the working class. Chess video games evolving from an easy sport in India now have policies that are set and standardized. There had been many changes to Chess, but the policies and standards of this game have not changed much for a reason at that time of chess.

Chess clubs have been additionally born in coffee houses inside the 1800s, and competition gradually improved into an extremely aggressive trend. Benjamin Franklin described the exceptional element about Chess in his article "Chess Ethics:" "Chess isn't simply an inactive passionate, but several valuable functions of the mind that are beneficial during human lifestyles are won and strengthened. By doing this, it will become an addiction with every occasion, because lifestyles are a sort of Chess, where we frequently refer to winning and competing with competition or opponents. There is a splendid style of enjoyable events. And there is the patient, to some extent, the impact of prudence or choice for it."—Benjamin Franklin, 1750.

An accurate Chess game accommodates people's status on one facet of the chessboard, which looks like a chessboard. The squares on the display screen represent spaces that use pieces to transport and seize other parts. In this sense, Chess is a sport/recreation of war, strategy, and domination.

This splendid manual talks approximately a step-by-step manual to discover ways to play Chess with the only strategies and start prevailing. You will also discover a whole other measurement in gameplay and Chess learning!

CHAPTER 1:

Key Concepts to Chess Openings and the Significance of Structure

Why Focusing on the Opening Matters?

So, you just bought this eBook entirely dedicated to Chess openings, and you might be asking yourself: "Seriously? An entire book just for the opening?"

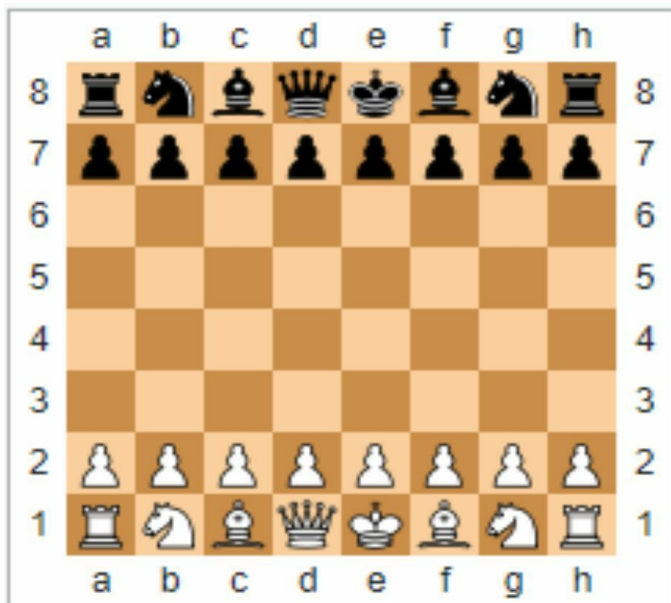
Believe it or not, this book cannot even begin to scratch the surface of all the research and study that has gone into the opening moves of Chess.

The reason is simple: if you start the game better than your opponent, you will have an advantage. In an ongoing effort to catch each other off-guard, even the most elite Chess players diligently study the opening to be better prepared than their opponent.

To understand what's going on with the opening moves, there are a few important ideas we will need to cover first.

They include control of the center, development, Pawn structure, open and closed positions, King safety, and transposition.

We will introduce these concepts to you here in the first chapter so we can move on and apply them to some of the most popular opening lines in Chess.



Navigating the Chessboard

For this book, we will be using the standard algebraic notation for Chess based on this chessboard diagram according to this terminology:

- Pawn: **C**
- Knight: **N**
- Bishop: **B**
- Queen: **Q**
- King: **K**
- Rook: **R**
- Castle kingside: **O-O**
- Castle queenside: **O-O-O**
- Capture: **X**
- Check: **+**
- Checkmate: **#**
- En Passant: **EP**

- Promotion: **CL=Q**
- Fantastic Move: **!**
- Dubious Move: **?**

Control of the Center

One of the goals of any good opening should be to gain control of the center squares of the board. We are mainly focusing on the d4, d5, e4, and e5 squares, although c4, c5, f4, and f5 are also important squares to consider as they help control those four most important squares. The classic approach to the opening is to occupy these squares directly with Pawns and support them with your pieces.

The more recent idea is to control the center indirectly with pieces, leaving Pawns in a safer position, and developing slowly. For this book, we are going to be taking a look at classical approaches as they best illustrate the principles of controlling and developing the center quickly.

By controlling the middle of the board with our Pawns, we will not only gain space to develop our other pieces behind our Pawns but limit the mobility of our opponent, hopefully causing them to have to choose the less ideal place for their pieces to not fall behind in development.

Imagine for a moment you are White, and you have a Pawn on d4 and e4, and your opponent hasn't moved any piece yet. Can you see how your Pawns create a wall blocking Black's access to the center? White is attacking all of the black's side central squares: c5, d5, e5, and f5. Now, if Black were to try to occupy any of those squares, White can either defend the attacked piece to keep up the wall or exchange whichever they prefer. The point is that White has the choice about what happens, and Black has to play within that understanding.

Now, in a real game, White doesn't get to move twice before Black does, only once, but the principle is the same. Because White has an ever so slight advantage by choosing the first move, he will always start the game with a small space advantage and time advantage (called a tempo) over Black.

As such, White usually starts to play with confidence, staking a claim to the middle immediately and challenging Black to find equality given White's inherent advantage. Black, on the other hand, hopes to prove that White has overextended himself and gain equality in the position by taking his share of the space and winning back some of the lost tempi if possible. It's time we take a look at the development and how to get our pieces moving effectively.

Development

When it comes to developing pieces of Chess, it must be said: don't move the same piece twice without a good reason. It doesn't mean to pass up on great opportunities should they arise, nor neglect your defense if moving that piece is your best option. Generally speaking, you should aim to develop all your other pieces first before moving that same piece twice if you can help it. If anyone has ever told you that you shouldn't bring your Queen out early in Chess, this is one of the key reasons why.

The Queen is incredibly powerful and, as such, is also valuable. While it might be tempting to swing out his Queen for a dramatic check early, chances are you are leaving your opponent with a valuable target to attack while also developing his own pieces. If you have to spend time running away while your opponent is making moves with his pieces, that means you are falling behind. For these reasons, most people develop their minor pieces first (Knight and Bishop) and use their major pieces in supportive roles (Rook and Queen). A typical opening from White is e4.

This move is the start of many famous Chess lines and is fantastic for several reasons. First, this move directly stakes a claim on the center by giving White control of the d5 and f5 squares. If you remember, those are two of the center squares that are very important for the opening. Also, by moving the Pawn out of the way, it leaves White with several great options for turn 2. White has the option to develop either Knight to great squares in Nc3 or for the Queen-side or Nf3 and Ne2 for the kingside. White could instead choose to deploy his light-colored Bishop anywhere along the a6-f1 diagonal. Finally, there is still the option to move another

Pawn, such as the popular King's Gambit. For Black, a typical response might be e4 c5.

The Sicilian Defense is a popular answer by Black to White's most common first move. This move stakes a claim in the center by occupying the c5 square and controlling the central d5 square White might have been eyeing otherwise. If you remember the position where White had a Pawn on both e4 and e5, it created a real blockade for Black to contend with. This simple flanking Pawn maneuver gives Black control of that central square by stopping that d5 move from being played right away.

Additionally, this move gives the Black Knight a great square on c6 to occupy when it wants to. The c Pawn has already moved ahead, so the Knight won't have to worry about getting out of the way for a future Pawn advance. Another general principle in the opening is to castle early. We will touch on this topic more in King Safety, but your opening moves should generally work towards preparing you for the castle. By following these steps, you will be making successful moves.

Pawn Structure

Let's imagine that White has Pawns arranged on a2, b3, c4, d5, e5, f4, g3, and h2. These diagonal formations of Pawns are called Pawn Chains. Notice how each Pawn behind defends and supports the Pawn ahead of it. Pawn chains can be as small as two Pawns chained together in a diagonal. These are power formations to use to give the White a strong defensible position to play behind.

The next concept to consider with Pawn structure is called Pawn Islands. Consider the same position as above but let's remove the c4 and f4 Pawns, meaning White has Pawns on a2, b3, d5, e5, g3, and h2. Do you notice how White's Pawns are separated into three separate groups? This means White now has three Pawn islands. In general, the more Pawn islands you have, the weaker your Pawns will be as they will be stretched thin and unable to defend one another.

An isolated Pawn is a single Pawn as an island with no Pawns on either side. Generally, isolated Pawns are considered a weak point

in the defense as only pieces can ever defend them. There are always exceptions, but generally, isolated Pawns are something you hope to avoid.

Double Pawns or even triple Pawns can occur, which is just a fancy name given when two or even three Pawns end up on the same file. In most cases, these Pawns are considered a weakness as the Pawns on the same file cannot help protect each other.

Finally, a passed Pawn is a Pawn that no enemy Pawn can stop, as it has "passed" their attack range. In a position with White having a Pawn on e4, it would be a passed Pawn if no Pawn on either the d or f file could stop it from advancing to promotion.

Open and Closed Positions

Open positions arise in openings where central Pawns are exchanged, and the center becomes more accessible. As the name suggests, these positions are filled with open spaces and long diagonals. As such, Rooks, Bishops, and the Queen all shine in these kinds of games, as they can best take advantage of the spaces. Closed games are ones where the Pawns are still on the board, usually locked in potential exchange, going many layers deep. These games are highly tactical and involve thinking many steps ahead in exchanges to determine who the potential victor would be in a big exchange in the middle. The theme of closed games is often maintaining the tension, as many times, the person who gives in to the pressure and attacks first comes out behind. In a closed position, Knights tend to shine a bit more as they are capable of maneuvering themselves around the tight battlefield better than most other pieces.

King Safety

If you develop pieces on both sides of the board before castling your King, you are opening yourself up to potentially devastating all-in attacks at very early turns in the game. The most extreme example of this is called the Fool's Mate, and it is the fastest way to lose a game of Chess. If you were curious: f3 e5 g4?? Qh4#.

However, it doesn't need to be as extreme as that to run into

problems. Many exciting professional Chess matches were decided by gutsy sacrifice attacks made against a King stuck in the middle of the board. Such is Chess, but for beginners, it is always best to start by keeping the defense of your King in mind.

This ties into the last point on King safety, and that is the Pawns around your King. It is rarely a good idea to advance the three Pawns in the corner you want to castle unless you really have to. Any time you advance one of these Pawns, you are creating a tiny weakness in the defenses around your King that your opponent can later try to use to attack you.

Transposition

Many openings have similar elements and can be reached in different move orders. Being able to move from one opening into another is called Transposition and is one of the ways great players can stay flexible in their opening moves while sticking to the same overall opening plan. In response to your opponent's moves, it might be preferable to change your move order, but that doesn't mean you have to go off into unknown territory. Look for ways to transpose from your deviation back into a position you are familiar with. This is how the best players can play Chess in positions they are unfamiliar with. They make reasonable moves looking to go back into familiar territory.

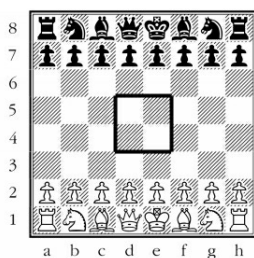
CHAPTER 2:

How to Develop Correctly Your Pieces

Every Chess game starts in the same position. White always moves first; after that, the two players alternate taking turns for the rest of the game. In master games, White has an advantage because he has the first move. However, for beginners, having the first move is only a slight advantage. The opening is typically the first eight to ten moves of the game. Although thousands of books have been written on Chess openings, all you need to know about the opening when you are learning to play is the basic principles:

Control the Center

The squares in the center (e4, e5, d4, and d5) are the most important on the board. By gaining control of these squares, you control more of the board and can launch an attack in any direction. Try to control the center squares with Pawns and protect them with your pieces. The squares on the edge of the board, or the rim, are the least important.



The center squares are e4, e5, d4, and d5.

Develop Your Pieces

Developing a piece means moving the piece of its starting square to a better square, usually toward the center of the board. The pieces you want to develop early are the Knights and Bishops. Remember

that Pawns are usually not called pieces and don't need to be developed.

Develop your pieces quickly and efficiently so each piece can get toward the center of the board in the least number of moves possible. Develop the minor pieces (Knights and Bishops) first, and then the major pieces (Rooks and Queens). Try not to block the diagonals of the Bishops with Pawns. The Rooks want to move to open files (files not blocked by your Pawns).

Do not bring out your Queen too early. If she enters the game too quickly, an experienced player will develop his pieces and attack the Queen at the same time, forcing you to move her again and waste time. If the player who brings the Queen out early isn't looking at his opponent's threats, the Queen usually gets captured quickly.

Castle Early

Castling is the second of the special moves (promoting a Pawn was the first). This is the only time that two pieces (King and Rook) can be moved in one turn. A player can only castle once per game. Castling allows you to safeguard the King by getting him out of the center of the board and to develop the Rook by bringing it toward the center and into the game.

Try not to push Pawns forward in front of a castled King because this opens up space in front of him, making the King more open to attack. Remember that Pawns cannot move backward later to defend the important squares in front of the King.

The King hides near the edge of the chessboard, out of the action for most of the game. However, the King is a powerful piece. The time to centralize the King is in the endgame (when most of the pieces are captured) because he is not likely to get checkmated when there are only a few pieces left on the board.

How to Castle

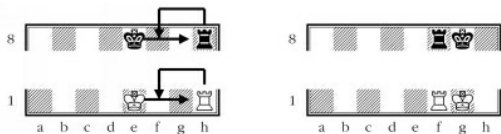
You can castle on either the kingside or the queenside. The kingside is the side of the board where the Kings start the game (e-

h files). The queenside is the side where the Queens begin the game (a-d files).

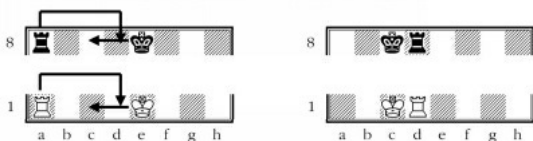
To castle kingside, the King Knight and King Bishop must move first, so the squares between the King and Rook are open. When castling, you must touch the King first because of the "touch move" rule (moving the Rook first would be a complete, legal Rook move). First, move the King two squares to the g-file (g1 for White and g8 for Black) and then, with the same hand, pick up the Rook and put it on the f-file (f1 for White and f8 for Black).

To castle queenside, the Queen, Queen Bishop, and Queen Knight must first be moved off of their starting squares. After that, pick up the King and move it two squares to the c-file (c1 for White and c8 for Black) and then, with the same hand, pick up the Rook and put it on the d-file square (d1 for White and d8 for Black). A simple way to remember this is that King moves two squares when castling on either side, and the Rook jumps over him.

Besides having all the pieces cleared out so that the King can "see" the Rook, it is also a requirement that the King has not already moved in the game and that the Rook that he is castling with also has not previously moved. You are also not allowed to castle to escape check, castle through a check, or castle into check.



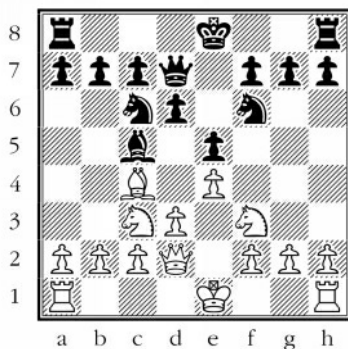
Castling Kingside



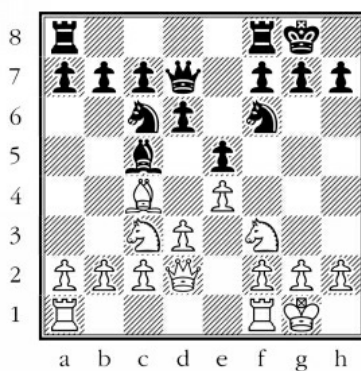
Castling Queenside

The diagrams on the next page show a position before castling, with both-side castled kingside, and with White castled on the queenside and Black castled on the kingside. In a real game, each player has the choice of which side to castle on or to not castle at

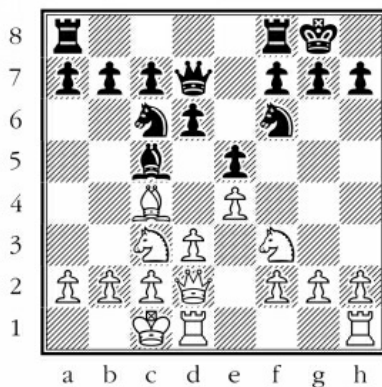
all. You can only castle once in the game.



Position before castling



In this position, both players castled kingside: White castled queenside and Black castled kingside.



The Categorization of the Chess Openings

The importance of establishing control early on in the game with timely and well-planned opening moves cannot be overemphasized. Beginners are encouraged to familiarize themselves with the theories and principles behind Chess openings to help them plan and prepare for their games. It will be easier to win games if you know how to use each piece to strengthen your position.

Basic Principles

Chess openings operate on the following basic principles:

1. It is a smart strategy to make the initial move with either the d-Pawn or e-Pawn moving two squares forward. This allows other pieces to move out of the back rank to join the fight for center supremacy.
2. Many successful opening strategies involve moving only one or two Pawns. Only this number is required for a player to control the center and allow fast development of other pieces. Take note that once you move the Pawn, it can never go back.
3. It is always a wise strategy to develop all pieces and advance each piece to its optimum position. You would want to take each piece early to a square where it can help you in the attack or defense of the central area. Well-planned openings seldom involve moving a piece twice in the opening phase.
4. It is always a good strategy to secure the King by castling early in the game and shielding it from sudden attacks and early checkmate. Castling does more than take the King off the busy center—it simultaneously develops one of the Rooks.
5. Developing your pieces while threatening your opponent's pieces will restrict the other player's options. This puts you on the

initiative and in the position to control the course of the game.

6. The opening moves lay the foundation for all Chess games, and it is important for a player who wants to be successful in the game to familiarize himself with the most common openings and to understand the rationale behind each move. Most game openings have been scrutinized and talked about for many years, and master players use them in their games systematically.

There are many known Chess openings and variants, and they have been analyzed, played, and replayed countless times. These moves range from quiet and deliberate to wild, novel, and tactical. Openings may be reasonably classified into the following main categories:

- Double King Pawn Opening (Open Games).
- Single King Pawn Opening (Semi-open Games).
- Double Queen Pawn Opening (Closed Games).
- Single Queen Pawn Opening (Semi-closed Games).
- Flank Openings.
- Irregular Openings.

Irregular first moves by White refer to initial moves other than the standard openings using the King Pawn, Queen Pawn, or pieces from the flank. These moves are not considered effective in exploiting the first-move advantage enjoyed by White and are therefore rarely used in competitions. Here are some examples of such moves and a quick analysis of why they are regarded as inferior opening moves.

1.g4 or 1.f3	Either of these moves weakens White's position.
1.Na3 or 1.Nh3	By taking it off the center duty, White is developing its Knight in an inferior position.
1.Na3 or 1.Nh3	The moves hardly have any impact on the control of the center or White's

	development.
1.a3, 1.a4, 1.h3, or 1.h4	These initial moves hardly have any impact on the control of the center or White's development.
1.d3, 1.e3, 1.c3, or 1.Nc3	These moves are simply too passive or conservative for White and do little to help it seize the centerboard.

CHAPTER 4:

Open Games

These openings are characterized by the moves 1. e4 e5. In general, open games provide excellent tactical opportunities for both camps. The Pawns on e4 and e5 control central and kingside squares, which allow quick development. This chapter will teach you how to play some of these openings correctly. You will also learn about fundamental opening principles.

Ruy López

1. e4 e5
2. Nf3 Nc6
3. Bb5



R

uy López was a priest from Spain who lived back in the 16th century. Some of the oldest recorded games are attributed to López and his frequent sparring partner, Giovanni Leonardo Di Bona, from Italy. Think of this, every time you sit down to play-through Chess, you share a bond with those like López who lived hundreds of years ago.

If you write your moves down, as yet unborn people will be able to replay your games long after you are gone and marvel at your

brilliance (or lack thereof).

Apart from his duties as a man of God, López also wrote one of the first books about Chess: "Libro de la Invención Liberal y Arte del Juego del Axedrez." (Book of the Liberal Invention and Art of Playing Chess;) 1561.

He penned it partly as a reply to an even earlier book, "Questo Libro e da Imparare Giocare a Scacchi et de li Partiti," which Pedro Damiano of Portugal had written half a century prior. López read the "Questo" on a trip to Rome, disliked it, and resolved to write a better Chess manual.

"Libro" contains some general strategic advice and a section on the historical origins of Chess.

It also includes the rules that were being used at the time, most of which are the same to this very day. Among the differences, "Libro" mentioned that a stalemate resulted in a win for the player, not stalemated rather than a draw.

A player could also win by capturing all his opponent's pieces, even if the enemy King remained un-checkmated.

If you have known the frustration of completely outplaying your opponent, only to have the game end drawn, you might wish that we could bring these old rules back.

López's book is the reason we call the above sequence of moves the "Ruy López." "Questo" (Damiano's older book) argued that after 1. e4 e5, 2. Nf3, Black's best next move was 2. Nc6. López disagreed with Damiano, arguing that 3. Bb5 "refuted" 2. Nc6. The claim was enough to affix López's name to the opening forevermore.

Today we know that 3. Bb5 is certainly not a refutation of 2. Nc6 and that the Ruy López opening is perfectly playable for Black. Bear in mind, "Libro" was written over 400 years ago, and López was blazing the trail of opening theory. We stand on the shoulders of our ancestors, and if we improve upon what they discovered, it shouldn't diminish their original achievement.

The Ruy López's opening (also known as the "Spanish Opening") has been studied endlessly in the intervening centuries. You could spend months and years delving into the various lines which the sharpest minds in Chess have pored over for all that time. Indeed, if you have any ambition to play Chess at the top level, this is exactly the sort of intensive study that will be required. The Ruy López's is one to avoid if you don't have much of an appetite for opening preparation, for you will quickly find yourself on the back foot if your opponent has crammed more theory into their head than you.

Later in life, Ruy López was elevated from the priesthood and became a Bishop of the religious kind, not the type found on a chessboard—although the mental image of this pious Spaniard moving around the cobblestones of his town exclusively diagonally is certainly an amusing one.

Italian Game



The Italian Game is a Chess opening that starts with 1. e4 e5, 2. Nf3 Nc6, and Bc4. It is one of the oldest Chess openings to be recorded. It appears in the Gottingen manuscripts, and it was used by such players as Polerio and Damiano during the sixteenth century and in 1920 by Greco, who gave it the main-line. The game has been rigorously evaluated for the last three hundred years, and it is sometimes interchangeably used with Giuoco Piano, although the term is used to refer to the move after 3. Bc5.

This opening is considered a Double King's Pawn game or Open game, and its defining move is moving the White Bishop to c4, as you anticipate an early attack on the vulnerable f7 square of your Black opponent. The game is therefore characterized by aggressive play, with the best chances of Black often being rigorous counterattacks. Many grandmasters tend to favor the Ruy Lopez instead of the Italian Game in terms of the opening move, as they consider it more advantageous for the long term.

Main Variations

1. 3. Bc5: this was the mainline of the Italian game until the 19th century. It was named the Giuoco Piano, which means the Quiet Game, contrary to the more volatile lines being developed. It advances 4. d3, or 4. c3, leading to the positions first assessed by

Greco during the seventeenth century and renewed by the Moller Attack at the turn of the twentieth century. This variation also includes the Jerome Gambit (4. Bxf7+), the Evans Gambit (4. b4), and the Italian Gambit (4. d4).

2. Nf6: this is also referred to as the two Knights defense, and it is more of a counterattack strategy. This move contains the aggressive Wilkes-Bare/Traxler variation, the sophisticated Max Lange Attack, and the Knife Edged Fegatello attack.

3. Be7: this is also known as the Hungarian defense and is a solid game that is usually used in tournaments in avoidance of the risks and complications of the other lines.

Giuoco Piano

- | | |
|--------|-----|
| 1. e4 | e5 |
| 2. Nf3 | Nc6 |
| 3. Bc4 | Bc5 |



If you want to learn a new discipline, you must be prepared to experience failure. You fall off your first horse, you forget your first foreign language lesson, and you bang your fingers when you hammer your first nail. So is it in Chess? As soon as a new player has learned the moves, they will be taught humility soon thereafter as others mercilessly exploit their frequent missteps.

But even if losing is what we expect when new to Chess, we will feel much better if we can at least give a respectable account of ourselves. There is a dignity to be found even in defeat if the struggle is well-fought. However, if we can't even last past the opening, there is only humiliation. Losing inside the first ten moves is the Chess equivalent of a first-round knockout. You can't help but detect that subtle superior smirk from your opponent, and you can't help but feel you didn't deserve to share the same board with them.

Such defeats for novices are most common in the sharper openings. There, they must navigate a veritable minefield and make correct move after correct move, lest their position explodes out from under them. To avoid this, the new Chess players will try to stick to openings where not too much can go too wrong, too quickly.

After 3. Bc4 (known as the "Italian Game") if Black responds with

3. Bc5, the opening is given an Italian name: Giuoco Piano, which means "quiet game." It is an opening that beginners gravitate towards because it reduces the possibility of rapid capitulation. Both sides follow the well-known opening maxims: develop pieces, occupy the center, and prepare to castle early. Neither player invites any immediate cut-and-thrust. If White's next move should be 4. d3, a related opening name is bestowed, Giuoco Pianissimo, or "Very Quiet Game."

The piano and Chess have much in common: both require deep and serious study, tend to attract introverts, and have links with mathematics. Some rare fellows have even had the distinction of excelling at both disciplines. Mark Taimanov was among the world's top 20 Chess players in the mid-20th century and was also a world-class concert pianist. Sergei Prokofiev, the Russian pianist, composer, and conductor, managed to beat future world Chess champion José Raúl Capablanca in a 1914 simul game.

Another thing shared by both Chess and the piano is the linkage to the past. When sitting down to Chess or a piano, the same tools are in use as all the great masters who have come before you. New music is composed, and the new Chess opening theory is advanced, but the 88 keys on a piano remain as they always have, as do the 32 pieces on a chessboard.

King's Gambit

This opening is played as such:

1. e4 e5
2. f4



Just like Ruy Lopez, King's Gambit opening is also one of the oldest openings in Chess. This opening provides White with a tremendous opportunity to develop pieces fast on the board. It is called a gambit since White sacrifices his Bishop Pawn in the process. It used to be quite popular in the 1800s, but it lost steam, and you will rarely see masters of the game making this move.

Nevertheless, it's still interesting to play. White can gain a positional advantage by taking the center quickly, but it also allows Black to gain a reasonable position.

King's Gambit Accepted

With the moves:

1. e4 e5
2. f4 exf4

We have reached the first position in the King's Gambit Accepted. It is white's turn to play now. If you remember back to our discussion about controlling the center, White was happy to have Pawns on both d4 and e4 as this gave them excellent control of the middle of the board, as well as options for all of their minor pieces to develop naturally. We will cover what d4 brings to the table in a lot more detail in the Queen's Gambit Opening. This is the most usual continuation for White, but sometimes White will instead elect to play Nf3 followed by Bc4's next turn to both stop Black from advancing their f4 Pawn, as well as to prepare to castle immediately.

King's Gambit Declined

After:

1. e4 e5

2. f4 b5

This is the King's Gambit Declined—Classical Defense. Black has developed his Bishop, as well as interfered with white's attempt to castle—as you cannot castle through check. You may be wondering why White wouldn't simply capture the Black e5 Pawn after Black neglects to protect it. Let's take a look at what happens if White takes the Pawn:

3. fxe5?? Qh4+

Suddenly White is in some real trouble. They are either going to lose the Rook after:

4. g3 Qxe4+

Do you notice how both the King and the Rook are being attacked? This is a tactic called "a Fork" because Black has forked White's King and Rook, Black is going to have to move his King and lose the Rook. If instead, White tries to run, the game ends swiftly:

5. Ke2 Qxe4#

We will take a deeper look into the King's Gambit during the next chapter.

Anderssen's Opening

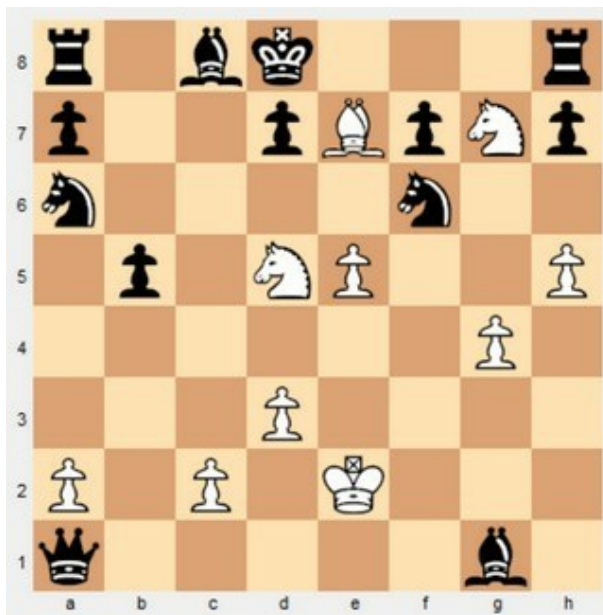
1. a3



Adolf Anderssen is a critical figure in Chess history, but the opening that bears his name is as fringe as the location of that Pawn on the edge of the board. Moving the a-Pawn ahead, a single square does not claim the center. White essentially throws away the first move advantage and invites Black to play as though the colors were reversed.

Anderssen was one of the 16 participants at the famous 1851 London knockout tournament. Anderssen upset Howard Staunton in the semi-finals and went on to triumph over one of Staunton's lesser-known countrymen in the final, thus emerging as the tournament's winner. This is the moment most Chess historians consider to be the end of Staunton's reign as the world's preeminent player.

Anderssen's most famous game was a casual encounter played against Lionel Kieseritzky that came to be known as "The Immortal Game." Played at Simpson's Divan in London, it saw Anderssen sacrifice a Bishop, both his Rooks and finally his Queen to deliver a stunning checkmate with his remaining three minor pieces. Although on the losing side, Kieseritzky knew that he had been part of something special, and he published the game in his journal, "La Régence," along with generous annotations.



The Immortal Game checkmates. Anderssen was White.

In 1858, Paul Morphy crossed the Atlantic from America to challenge the great European masters. As Anderssen was regarded as the best in Europe, he became the standard-bearer for the old world against this challenger from the new—all the more so because Howard Staunton didn't play Morphy at all.

By the time Anderssen faced Morphy, the American had developed a fearsome reputation. Morphy had already dispatched several formidable European players, so Anderssen was looking everywhere for advantage ahead of their match. Perhaps, was it an unexpected opening move to unsettle Morphy's preparation? Sure enough, Anderssen started with 1. a3 three times as White throughout their match. Morphy must have been taken aback by this strange move. Yet in these three games, Anderssen achieved an even 1 ½ point out of 3. Not bad, especially considering that over the entire match, Anderssen was summarily crushed, losing seven, drawing two, and winning two.

Having proven himself superior to all-comers, Morphy is generally recognized as the strongest player in the world. But then, as you will read about in greater detail in Morphy's chapter, he went back

to America and abandoned Chess. With Morphy out of the picture, Anderssen again assumed the mantle of the world's best until he lost a close match against Wilhelm Steinitz in 1866.

If you decide to play Anderssen's Opening, rest assured that it will dumbfound your opponent. But psychological impact aside, if Black just plays to simple principles (develops pieces, controls the center, castles, and connects rooks), 1. a3 should not be troubling.

Evans Gambit

- | | |
|--------|-----|
| 1. e4 | e5 |
| 2. Nf3 | Nc6 |
| 3. Bc4 | Bc5 |
| 4. b4 | |



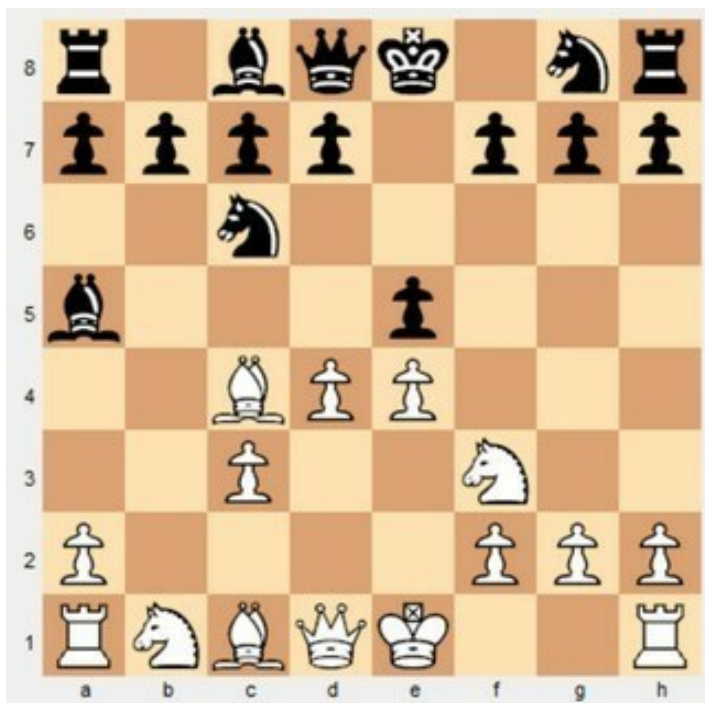
Chess has been referred to as "The Royal Game" thanks to the favor it historically gained with Kings, courtiers, and the landed gentry. In the 18th century and earlier, the nobility were the only ones who had enough excess money and free time that they could afford to lounge around and move little figurines around a 64-square board. The poor were understandably more concerned with mere survival and had no time for such frivolity.

This makes the Evans Gambit interesting, for it was not named after a member of the upper classes. While the family of the Welshman William Evans was sufficiently well-off to send their child to a grammar school, the lad had no life of idle leisure to look forward to. Evans became a sailor, and his early years saw him voyage off to distant ports in the West Indies and the

Mediterranean Sea. Eventually, he rose to be appointed captain of a Post Office steamship that made short, regular journeys back and forth between Milford Haven in Wales and Waterford in Ireland.

These routine crossings of St. George's Channel left Evans with plenty of downtimes to study Chess. One day, he came up with the startling 4. b4 move after the typically conservative Giuoco Piano (3. Bc5). If Black is expecting a quiet start to the game, then 4. B4 instantly shakes him from his slumber.

To the uninitiated, the Evans Gambit looks like an awful gaffe from a rank beginner; Black can simply capture the undefended Pawn with 4. Bxb4. But this is exactly White's plan—that Pawn is sacrificed to gain rapid development. One continuation sees White play 5. c3, forcing Black's Bishop away to 5. Ba5, and then White surges forward in the center with 6. d4.



Position after 6. d4.

While on shore leave in London, Captain Evans played his gambit in a game against the leading British player of the early 19th century, Alexander McDonnell. McDonnell was checkmated in just

20 moves, leaving him stunned but also impressed by the novel opening that had just been used to beat him. When William Lewis, another influential British Chess figure, later wrote an analysis of the move in a book of all known openings, he referred to it as "Evan's Gambit." Thus, the name was confirmed.

All of this was happening in the 1830s and 1840s when Chess was at last growing past society's old dividing lines. A middle class, with better incomes and more leisure time, was on the rise. No longer was Chess exclusively "The Royal Game," and what's more, the masses could now play the Evans Gambit, an opening named after an ordinary sea captain.

Away from the chessboard, Evans also invented a naval lighting system that prevented collisions between ships at night. For this lifesaving discovery, he was awarded the then handsome amount of £1,500 by an appreciative British government and a further £200 and a gold chronometer from the Tsar of Russia. For his famous Chess gambit, Evans was awarded nothing of monetary value, but he did get lasting fame, which is something that money can't buy.

CHAPTER 5:

Semi-Open Games

Semi-open games start with 1. e4. However, instead of answering with the symmetrical 1e5, the Black player uses a different move to achieve early equality.

This chapter will teach you three of the most popular semi-open Chess openings.

Study these openings carefully because they can be used to surprise your opponents who expect open games.

E4—This move opens the d1-h5 diagonal for the Queen and the f1-a6 diagonal for the King's Bishop.

Chess players consider this as the most aggressive first move. Aside from opening valuable diagonals, the Pawn move attacks the d5 and f5 squares.

Black has a wide range of options regarding his first move. In this chapter, you will learn about 1 c5 (also called Sicilian Defense), 1 e6 (also called French Defense), and 1 c6 (also called Caro-Kann Defense).

Sicilian Defense



Easily the most popular and statistically successful opening for Black to the nearly universally played 1. e4 from White. While visually similar to the English Opening: Reverse Sicilian, this is a much older opening with a full and rich history. Indeed, enough has been said on the Sicilian to fill several books in their entirety with this opening alone. Let's start by analyzing the opening move from Black c4. Just like in the Reverse Sicilian for White, Black aims to control the center of the board from a flanking wing Pawn, keeping their important d and e Pawns for a potential break in the middle later. Again, if Black could ever trade their c Pawn for White's d Pawn, he could see that as a slight advantage over White, as he could then have a central Pawn majority over the White player. As we have seen before, the advanced c Pawn also provides a great outpost for black's queenside Knight that is a major factor in how the game usually plays out. From a theoretical standpoint, Black is starting to lay a claim to the dark-colored squares in the center of the board. Imagine for a moment that Black could achieve their goal of a Knight on c6 as well as the eventual move e5. Notice the grip that Black would have on all those central dark squares. The c Pawn gives control over b4, and d4, the hypothetical Pawn on e5 targets the d4 and f4 dark squares, and a Knight on c6 could exert its influence on a5, b4, d4, and helps protect e5. This is a very common theme for Black to try and have a rock-solid grip on the dark squares, especially d4, where White would otherwise have plans of eventually making a break with moves like c3 and d4.

Lastly, to further show dark-square dominance, a common strategy for Black will be to fianchetto their dark square Bishop at g7, giving them even greater control over those squares. There are two mainline variations to the Sicilian Defense, called the Open and Closed Variations. Let's take a look at the Open Sicilian first:

Open Sicilian Defense



The main Open line goes as follows:

1. e4 c5
2. Nf3 d6
3. d4

White develops their kingside Knight, preparing to castle shortly. White is also taking a chance to control more of the center of the board, especially those dark squares we know Black is so keen on in d4 and e5. Black has other options for his second move other than d6. However, this is the most common reply. The move d6 by Black creates a Pawn chain with the c5 Pawn, solidifying the defense of that Pawn. Additionally, it opens a path for the light-square Bishop to activate along the c8-h3 diagonal.

Finally, this move prepares Black to play their kingside Knight to f6. Notice how if Black played the Knight move immediately, as in 2. Nf3 Nf6, White could cause some real problems for Black with the simple move: e5, threatening to capture our freshly developed Knight and taking a lot of central space. Best to avoid that scenario

with the preparatory move d6. There are, of course, many other ways Black could respond after Nf3, which we can touch on in the next chapter. From here, the main continuation is:

4. D4cxd4

5. Nxd4Nf6

6. Nc3

Black has achieved one of his goals of exchanging his c Pawn in for White's d pawn. Black continues to develop the kingside Knight now that White can't disturb it with their e Pawn because of the d6 Pawn protecting the e5 square for us. White continues development with Nc3.

In this position, Black will try to prove that his central Pawn majority is winning and has a clear advantage. White, on the other hand, has a significant lead in piece development, as well as more control over the center of the board, which he will argue, giving him more than fair compensation for his d Pawn.

Closed Sicilian



The mainline looks like this:

1. e4 c5

2. Nc3 Nc6

And here, Black will develop similarly to in the open Sicilian but not always in the same order. Black has goals they wish to accomplish and not a rigid attack plan requiring a strict move order. We want that Knight on c6, and usually, we want our Bishop to fianchetto on g7 (notice how the Black Pawn chain is otherwise in the way for Black to put his Bishop on a meaningful square. Fianchetto is a great way to solve this problem!). We get our queenside Knight into the game on its favorite square now as well. This is a great example of why Knights like to be behind pawns.

Look at the difference between the two Knights on the c file. Notice how Black's c Pawn has contributed to his plan in a significant way. White would love to be able to play moves like c3 and d4 and grab some of that juicy center, but right now, his Knight on c3 is in the way! This is one of the major draws for players who enjoy playing flank openings such as the English and the Sicilian.

Let's see what is considered to be mainline, but again this move order can vary significantly:

3. g3g6

4. Bg2Bg7

5. d3d6

Both White and Black have the same idea here: My Pawns are in the way, and I need to get my kingside Bishop into the game somehow. Once again, a fianchetto is an answer, and in this case, both sides will usually opt for this strategy, as they are both being walled in by their Pawn chain. White's Pawn on e4 is still on the way—for now.

White can at any time open a discovered attack with a cheeky move like e5, both attacking black's Pawn chain (assuming it is played after d6 from Black) and disrupting the scope of Black's bishop.

Both sides solidify their Pawn structure by creating Pawn chains in turn 5 with d3 and d6, respectively.

From here, both sides will develop their last pieces and castle, and

we have reached a stable and about equal position to start a mid-game.

Both sides have great chances here, and many fantastic positional games have been reached from this opening.

Caro-Kann's Defense

1. e4 c6



The Caro-Kann Defense is named after two men: Horatio Caro of the United Kingdom and Marcus Kann from the Austro-Hungarian Empire.

Neither were especially high profile, occupying that rung of the Chess world just below the genuinely elite players.

Caro was born in England but spent most of his career in Berlin. He was a regular in the Berlin city Chess championship, winning it five times. His best individual wins were over Emanuel Lasker in 1890 and over Semyon Alapin in 1897.

Kann was from Vienna and had his most famous victory when he beat Jacques Mieses in just 17 moves at the 1885 German Chess Congress while playing what is now called the Caro-Kann Defense.

A year after that win, Caro and Kann worked together on developing the theory on the 1. c6 move and co-published an article in a German magazine called *Brüderschaft*. Consequently, the opening became known as the Caro-Kann Defense.

The Caro-Kann Defense prepares Black for a d5 break with a

supporting pawn. White's most common next move is 2. d4, which Black will usually reply to with 2. d5.



Position after 2. d5. The mainline Caro-Kann Defense.

C6 was known about as far back as the 16th century but never really caught on in the age of aggressive gambits and center occupation.

It took decades after Caro and Kann's 1886 analysis for the best players to become advocates for the move.

Black's light-squared Bishop is freer than in the French Defense, and Black can often get to an endgame with a better Pawn structure. Respect has continued to grow, and these days it is a mainstay of many players' repertoires.

Nimzowitsch Defense

1. e4 Nc6



Aron Nimzowitsch was born in Riga (in present-day Latvia) in 1886 and was introduced to Chess by his father, who was one of the best players in the city.

The elder Nimzowitsch had made a fortune in the timber trade and wanted Aron to join the family business, but the young man cared little for the life of a merchant and only wanted to spend his time playing Chess.

When it became clear that Aron wouldn't be following in his father's footsteps, he instead went away to a German university to study mathematics and philosophy.

But Aron's studies bored him, and he spent most of his time in Chess cafés.

Nimzowitsch entered his first international tournaments, did well, and had a promising Chess career to look forward to.

But around this time, World War I hit. Riga was devastated, and Nimzowitsch's family lost much of their fortune.

So, like many Chess masters, Nimzowitsch headed to Scandinavia, which had been untouched by the conflict.

There, he made a good living by giving private Chess lessons, delivering lectures, and playing in simultaneous matches.

Nimzowitsch is best known as the foremost hypermodern player. Some argue the genesis of the entire hypermodern of Chess School can be traced back to a single 1904 game Nimzowitsch played

against Siegbert Tarrasch. Tarrasch was more than 20 years Nimzowitsch's senior and was a highly respected figure in chess.

Early in the game, Tarrasch leaned back, looked at the result of Nimzowitsch's rather unconventional opening play, and exclaimed: "Never in my life have I had such a won game after 10 moves as I have now!" Nimzowitsch never forgot the insult. From then on, the two men engaged in a bitter argument, mostly played out in publicly read columns, about what constituted "proper" Chess: Tarrasch's old-school "positional" style, or Nimzowitsch's radical new "hypermodern" movement.

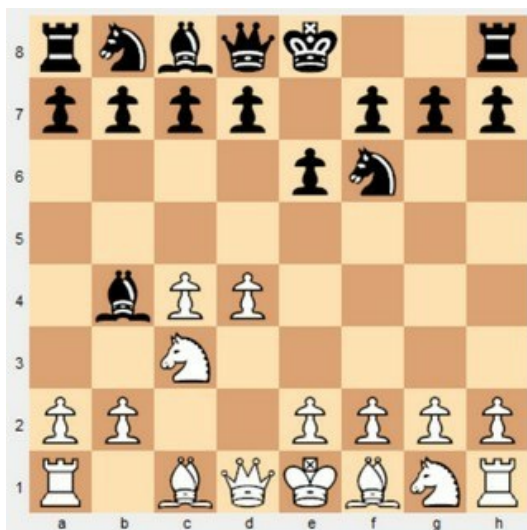
When Nimzowitsch's career started, the opening theory was based on symmetrical center Pawn formations, so playing a Knight out on the first move was quite groundbreaking. In the space of just a couple of decades, Nimzowitsch and others like Richard Réti and Savielly Tartakower had proven that moves like these in the opening were perfectly playable.

These days, the Nimzowitsch Defense proper is unusual. Far more common is the "Nimzo-Indian," a variation of the Indian Defense that Nimzowitsch pioneered as a response for Black to 1. d4, with a similar flank philosophy.

1. d4 Nf6

2. c4 e6

3. Nc3 Bb4



The Nimzo-Indian Defense after three moves:

Nimzowitsch was extremely patient in the middle game and was particularly adept at giving his opponent difficult choices.

If a game can be steered towards a situation where you have many possible decent moves, but your opponent must keep finding a single correct move, then they will probably make a mistake eventually.

One of Nimzowitsch's favorite strategies was to overprotect his position and wait for his opponent to do something rash out of frustration.

His personality was rather over-sensitive and irritable. Once, when

Nimzowitsch lost a game at a blitz tournament, he stood on the table and yelled "Why must I lose to this idiot?!" Many of us have felt such an urge after a particularly galling loss, but it takes a special type of gumption to follow through and commit the act!

In 1929, Nimzowitsch placed first at a strong tournament in Carlsbad (in the modern-day Czech Republic).

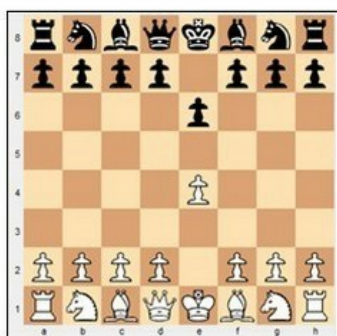
His playing strength made him a clear candidate to challenge for the world championship, but he couldn't raise the necessary stake to secure a match with Alexander Alekhine, especially with the world in the grips of the Great Depression.

Nimzowitsch declined in playing strength after that and died of pneumonia a few years later, aged 48.

He was never the world champion, but through his writings and advocacy for revolutionary openings, his influence on Chess has still been extremely profound.

French Defense

1. e4 e6



France occupies a central place in Chess history, and the French Defense is one of chess's most solid and resilient center Pawn openings.

The French embraced the game like nowhere else in the 18th and early 19th-century. Chess cafés were incredibly prolific there, and French players monopolized the mantle of world preeminence for generations: Legall de Kermeur, François-André Danican Philidor,

Louis-Charles Mahé de La Bourdonnais, and Pierre Charles Fournier de Saint Amant all followed one another in succession until the 1840s. Today, the international Chess federation is known as "FIDE," which is a French acronym for "Fédération Internationale des Échecs." French words turn up elsewhere in the game, too, such as the en passant Pawn capture rule and j'adoube, said when adjusting a piece's position on a square without violating the touch-move rule.

The French Defense may seem that Black is too timid to push the Pawn all the way to meet its opposite, but the next moves reveal more aggression. White usually continues with 2. d4, which Black may meet with 2. d5.



Position after 2. d5:

What White does next can vary, but often Black will target White's d4 Pawn by playing c5 at some point—just the kind of flank attack that the French general Napoleon Bonaparte was famous for in his early conquests through Europe.

Napoleon, the French Emperor from 1804 to 1814, had a deep love for Chess.

It is, after all, a game of war, and over the years, many battle commanders have turned to Chess for inspiration.

On the real battlefield, Napoleon had an uncanny knack for sensing the intentions of the enemy and controlling the course of the battle, but on the chessboard, he was mediocre at best.

Perhaps the fact a military commander's prowess does not transfer to ability at Chess is unsurprising—a game with fixed rules played

in silence by two equal forces on a square board is a long way removed from the chaos of actual combat.

The French Defense got its name from a correspondence match between the cities of London and Paris in 1834. Chamomile, one of the players of the Parisian team, persuaded his team to play the (at the time) quite novel 1. e6, which proved to be the Londoner's undoing.

For the Paris club, winning must have been particularly sweet given that France's defeat in the Napoleonic Wars was still fresh in the memory. At last, a French victory!

Modern Defense



Moves: 1. e4 g6

This opening has been utilized to capture the opponent off guard in certain games, even though it isn't used regularly. This opening sets out to encourage the Dark player but ends up supporting the White player gains an edge over the Dark player. As in the instance of this Alekhine's defense, the White Pawns are motivated to proceed forward to establish a good Pawn structure in the middle.

This paves way for the Dark to assault round the middle. Exactly enjoy the Alekhine's defense; this opening exerts some benefit and restores balance in the game. Since White won't be able to forecast the upcoming movements of Black, this opening may be employed by Black to establish an aggressive assault.

At precisely the same time, this opening helps White in embracing an offensive strategy since there's sufficient chance for White to create a solid center. Having a solid center makes it possible and easy for White to establish an aggressive assault against the Black.

Even though it has several virtues, this opening is preferred by the players since it inclines to complicate the game, and frequently, players have been left with no thought about what is the next movement of the opponent. This lack of predictability and clarity Related to this Opening is the most important cause of its lack of popularity.

Scandinavian Defense

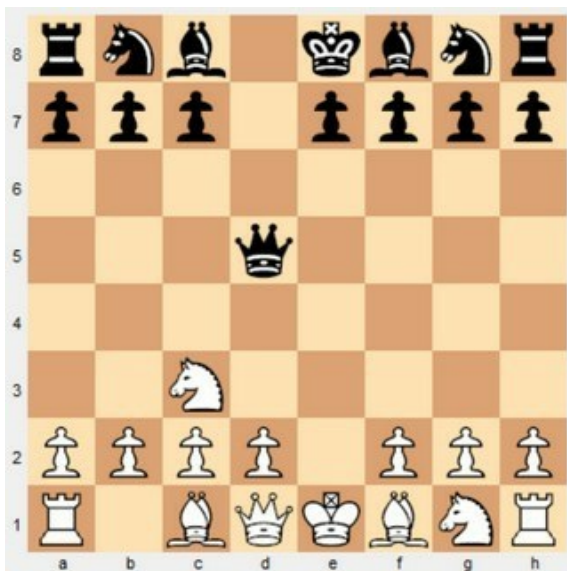
1. e4 d5



In the French Defense, Black plays 1. e6, preparing 2. d5. And in the Caro-Kann Defense, Black plays 1. c6, again to support a 2. d5 surge. In the Scandinavian Defense, Black doesn't bother with any such groundwork and simply thrusts forward by playing 1. d5 immediately.

Modern Scandinavians are held up as exemplars of civilization. On the whole, they are a blond-haired, IKEA-shopping, egalitarian, politically progressive people. This belies their history, for they are descended from the bloodthirsty Vikings, who made their name by pillaging and terrorizing northern Europe during the Dark Ages. The Vikings would go forth in their fearsome longboats, set ashore, and, once they had their fill of plunder, return to their frigid homeland and drink from the skulls of their victims.

The Scandinavian Defense echoes the Scandinavian's vicious past far more than their mild-mannered present. It is a combative opening where the ill-prepared opponent can quickly be vanquished, just like the unsuspecting villagers set upon by the Vikings in days of yore. In the mainline, White captures the offered Pawn with 2. exd5, Black wastes no time in recapturing with 2. Qxd5, and White gains a tempo by bringing out his Knight and threatening the queen: 3. Nc3. All of this is expected by the prepared Scandinavian player. It is immediate hand-to-hand warfare.



Position after 3. Nc3:

The website chessgames.com features a vast database of recorded Chess games going back hundreds of years. The very oldest game they have on record is a Scandinavian Defense, played in Valencia, Spain, in 1475. To put that in historical context, the game in question took place before Christopher Columbus had sailed to America!

The Scandinavian Defense gained its name mainly thanks to Ludvig Collijn, who served as chairman of the Swedish Chess Federation from 1917 to 1939. In his earlier days, Collijn competed at the 1897 Nordic Chess championship where, as Black, he responded consistently to 1. e4 with 1. d5. Collijn finished a respectable eighth in the tournament, which was incidentally won by a man called Sven Otto Svensson, which is quite possibly the most Swedish name imaginable.

But how did it come to pass that the tournament that gave the opening its name was the Nordic Chess championship, yet Scandinavian was bestowed on it? It's the manifestation of an extremely common error; people often conflate "Scandinavian" and "Nordic" with each other, but they are not the same. The term "Scandinavia" includes the three kingdoms of Denmark, Norway, and Sweden. The languages of these countries retain enough

similarities that Danes, Swedes, and Norwegians all understand one another to this day. Often, outsiders mistakenly include Finns and Icelanders when referring to Scandinavians, but strictly speaking, Iceland and Finland are Nordic countries, but not Scandinavian. Finnish and Icelandic people find Scandinavian tongues incomprehensible, and as Michael Booth joked in *The Almost Nearly Perfect People*, at Nordic Council meetings, the Finns and Icelanders tend to be found in a corner away from everyone else, speaking in English to one another.

The best player Scandinavia has ever produced was the 21st-century world champion Magnus Carlsen of Norway. He was a grandmaster at 13. At the same age, he managed to draw a rapid game against Garry Kasparov, the world number one at the time—a sensational result for someone so young. Carlsen continued to improve as he moved into adulthood, and he captured the coveted world crown from Vishy Anand in 2013.

In an era where computers reign supreme over elite human players, Carlsen plays the most like a machine out of anyone without a silicon brain. He thrives in the long-term strategy of the middle game and is unbelievably tenacious in the endgame. Like a computer, he seemingly doesn't make mistakes once most of the pieces are off the board.

Carlsen doesn't play the Scandinavian Defense often—he is very much a modern Scandinavian, with no taste for flesh and blood of his Viking ancestors or the double-edged positions this opening is known for. He even supplements his Chess earnings through fashion modeling.

Alekhine's Defense

1. e4 Nf6



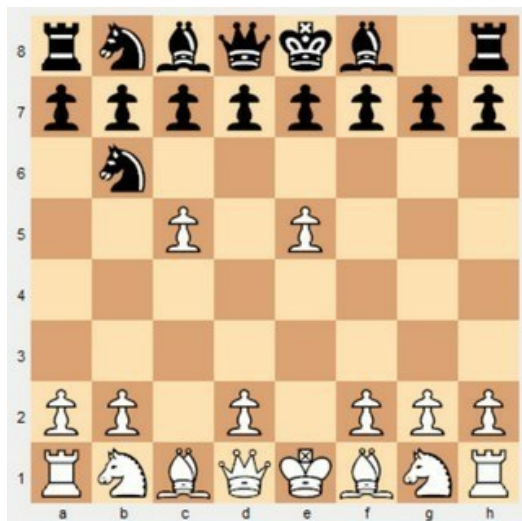
No other Chess opening so perfectly captures the personality of the man it is named after as Alekhine's Defense. Alexander Alekhine was the fourth world champion and was an unorthodox character, even by Chess standards.

Serious players of the early 20th century would have been incredulous if they saw 1. Nf6, but when Alekhine kept winning with it against top opposition, everyone realized the move could no longer be dismissed with a casual wave of the hand.

The opening seems highly implausible at first. The mainline sees White make the obvious advance 2. e5, chasing the Knight with a near forced 2. Nd5.

Then, White can choose to keep harassing with 3. c4, compelling the Knight over to the other side of the board from where it started; 3. Nb6.

Though not normal, next move, White even has the option of 4. c5, which will mean the well-traveled Knight must again find a new square.



Position after 4. c5. In this line, Black's Knight will need to move four times in the first four moves.

Alekhine's Defense breaks two of opening theory's most important dictums: "do not move your pieces more than once in the opening" and "control the center." Black has moved the same Knight two, three, or even four times and given up complete control of the center to White by allowing all these Pawn moves with tempo.

The Alekhine Defense is not just played in the hope of springing a trick on the unwary. Although White is ceded a clear space advantage, White's advanced center Pawns form a broad target for Black to attack. Even after decades of analysis, it remains unclear which player this favors. A deep study of the Alekhine Defense is like teasing out the thoughts of a mad genius.

Alekhine had been born into an aristocratic Russian family, a fact which placed him in the firing line when the Communist revolution of 1917 took hold. He fled to France and competed under the French flag in the latter half of his career. Eventually, he was granted full French citizenship.

To say Alekhine was "obsessed" by Chess wouldn't be doing him justice. He spent every waking moment on it and lost all interest in social contact. When he wasn't playing, he was studying. When he wasn't studying, he was writing. Once invited to a theater

performance, he sat completely disinterested in the production unfolding on the stage, preferring to play (against himself) with his pocket Chess set. He even named his cats "Chess" and "Checkmate!"

Alekhine won his world title in 1927 from José Raúl Capablanca of Cuba. Apart from Chess, the two men had nothing in common. Picture the opposite of Alekhine-charming, naturally relaxed, sartorially splendid, and dashing handsome—that was Capablanca.

Alekhine's victory against the Cuban came as a surprise to most, not least to the players themselves. Capablanca was so confident that he barely even bothered preparing, and even Alekhine regarded himself as unlikely to win. Alekhine had never beaten Capablanca before the 1927 title contest, and the defending world champion had recently enjoyed an amazing eight-year undefeated streak between 1916 and 1924. Yet Alekhine's single-minded work ethic saw his challenge succeed. Having beaten his rival once, Alekhine was accused of dodging Capablanca's desire for a rematch and often went out of his way to avoid tournaments Capablanca was playing in.

Alekhine's reign as world champion was punctuated by a shock loss to Max Euwe in 1935. Alekhine was struggling with alcoholism, and matters were not helped by the fact the match was held in the Netherlands (Euwe's home country), where the Dutch hosts slyly plied Alekhine with as much free champagne as he wanted. After losing his crown, Alekhine sobered up, refocused, and crushed the Dutchman in the 1937 rematch.

The darkest stain on Alekhine's character comes from his links to the Nazis during World War II. He played in seven tournaments in Germany while the conflict was raging. But worst of all, a series of articles titled Aryan Chess and Jewish Chess was written under Alekhine's name, denouncing the way Jews played Chess as empty, cowardly, and materialistic, thus supporting exactly the kind of propaganda the Nazis were spreading about the Jewish people in general.

These writings blasted Steinitz and Lasker (both Jews) for playing

too defensively, which unfortunately had a kernel of truth to it—their positional play was more defensive than the attacking style of the romantic era that had preceded them. It also blamed the hypermodern movement (and the many Jewish adherents, including Nimzowitsch and Réti) for nearly destroying the game with what was termed "cheap bluff" and a "fear to struggle."

As soon as Europe was liberated from the Nazis, Alekhine publicly disavowed the articles and even denied ever writing them, contending he had been forced to publish them in his name by the occupying forces. Evidence to the contrary emerged when the original copies of the articles were later found in Alekhine's handwriting. It remains contentious whether this anti-Semitism was what Alekhine truly believed or if these words were penned under duress.

In March 1946, a world championship match was organized between Alekhine and a challenger from the USSR, Mikhail Botvinnik. But before the match could take place, Alekhine took the world championship title to the grave by dropping dead in his hotel room, aged 53. Some say it was a heart attack, some say he choked on his dinner, but the more sinister version of the story tells of a murder most foul carried out by the Soviet KGB to secure the world title for their own man.

Pirc's Defense

1. e4 d6
2. d4 Nf6
3. Nc3



"Vasja Pirc" is a name that everybody gets wrong. Normally when a foreign name is Anglicized, the English spelling is suggestive of its pronunciation. Not so for Pirc—his name is correctly articulated as "Peerts," not "Perk." Due to the reorganization of national borders in the 20th-century, a quick history lesson is necessary to explain where Pirc came from.

Pirc was born in the Austro-Hungarian Empire, which was a union between the kingdoms of Austria and Hungary and the lands they had annexed. When the empire found itself on the losing side of World War I, it dissolved.

Yugoslavia was formed when some of the old empire's lands were joined by some new areas. Pirc won the national Chess championship of Yugoslavia five times and died a Yugoslav in 1980. But just over a decade later, Yugoslavia itself fragmented into several independent countries because of inter-ethnic tensions and the collapse of the former heavy-handed regime. Now the area in which Pirc spent his life is known as Slovenia.

Pirc's best Chess was in the 1930s. He was the sort of player who was good enough to be invited to the top tournaments but not so strong that he would win them. Still, he played plenty of Chess against the game's leading lights, including Max Euwe, Savielly

Tartakower, Aron Nimzowitsch, Emanuel Lasker, and Alexander Alekhine.

World War II saw Pirc's home city of Ljubljana occupied by the Axis forces. The war put a stop to European Chess tournaments, so Pirc contented himself by meeting every Tuesday with another local grandmaster, Milan Vidmar. During the war, they reportedly played around 1,000 games.

When international competition finally resumed, Pirc represented Yugoslavia. His country hosted and won the ninth Chess Olympiad in 1950—the first Olympiad held since the fateful 1939 tournament, which trapped all those players in Argentina at the war's outbreak (see the chapter on Najdorf for that story).

The Pirc Defense sees White establish himself in the center, which Black aims at from the sides. The Classical line of the Pirc Defense sees Black continue with a kingside fianchetto:



Position after 4. Bg7:

This series of moves had been seen sporadically in the 1800s but was considered irregular. Calling an opening "irregular" is the deepest insult that can be razed at it, usually reserved for moves like 1. b4 and 1. g4. But Vasja Pirc was convinced that this opening had merit and could give Black a fine game. Largely through his writing and results, he succeeded in gaining a following for it, leading the Chess world to bestow Pirc's name on it.

By the 1960s, the Pirc Defense had well and truly been reclassified as playable. Pirc's heart must have swelled with pride when he lived to see his opening played in game 17 of the 1972 world Chess championship between Bobby Fischer and Boris Spassky, who played as White and Black, respectively. Incidentally, the game finished drawn.

But everyone still messes up Pirc's surname. Even though you now know better, I bet you have still been pronouncing it "perk" in your head the whole time you have been reading this.

Grünfeld's Defense

- | | |
|--------|-----|
| 1. d4 | Nf6 |
| 2. c4 | g6 |
| 3. Nc3 | d5 |



Ernst Grünfeld of Austria was born into poverty. He lost a leg early in his life, a disability which rather restricted his choice of activities. An account from Hans Kmoch describes his tragedy: "While other children played, he could only watch; while other young men found romance, he could only sit silently by. He remained handicapped in education, conversation, behavior, and the ability to earn a livelihood."

Fortunately, Grünfeld found Chess. He studied it ardently and became a respected player at his local club. Austere circumstances in post-World War I Austria made travel difficult, but he kept practicing through correspondence games through the mail. Though his modest means did not permit him the luxury of a

proper library, he collected notes on whatever available scraps of paper he could find. Grünfeld's hard work and excellent memory soon earned him a reputation as an authority on Chess openings. He lived for decades in a tiny Vienna flat with his wife and daughter and filled one room with his books and writings about Chess, including some 40 filing cabinets.

The Grünfeld Defense is a key hypermodern opening which became famous when Grünfeld beat a Serbian master named Boris Kostić in 1922 at Teplitz-Schönau (in the modern-day Czech Republic). Grünfeld also used the same opening later that year to defeat the future world champion, Alexander Alekhine. It is frequently said that Alekhine spectacularly ended this game; rather than dipping his King in resignation, he picked the piece up and hurled it across the room! Now that's how to go out in style.

Though Grünfeld competed regularly on the international circuit in the 1920s, wins over men of Alekhine's caliber were rare. Grünfeld mainly played solid openings which seldom troubled his sternest opponents. One of his weaknesses was he invariably played 1. d4 as White because he considered any other first move to be a "mistake." This lack of variety made it significantly easier for others to prepare for games against him.

Grünfeld was more than a little eccentric. Once, he woke at four o'clock and was aghast, for he knew he had a game to play at five o'clock that day. He rushed outside, and when a team didn't come immediately, he took it upon himself to walk the whole way to the tournament venue (not easy, remember, for he had just one leg). Only once he arrived did he realize his mistake: the tournament was to start at five o'clock in the evening, but Grünfeld had turned up at five o'clock in the morning.

Closed Games

The Queen's Gambit

1. d4 d5
2. c4 e6



In this opening, White offers to sacrifice his c-Pawn in exchange for control of the center and easy development. Black usually does not accept the sacrifice, as Black does not want to leave White with two Pawns in the center while Black only has one. Therefore, Black usually declines the sacrifice with a move like e6, supporting his center. White's c-Pawn isn't that important anyway, so Black wouldn't be getting that much of an advantage if he won white's c-Pawn (the d, e, and f-Pawns are much more important as the e and d-Pawns control the Center, and the f-Pawn protects the King).

The Queen's gambit is very popular at professional level play and leads to complex games where both tactics and strategy are needed to get the most out of the position. The games are usually a bit slower than e4 openings such as the Ruy Lopez or the Guiooco Piano, and a lot of the action happens in the center, where things often get blocked.

Let's have a look at how a Queen's Gambit game might go:

3. Nc3 Nf6

4. Bg5 Be7

5. E3 0-0



So far, White's moves have all been focused on either attacking the d5 Pawn or attacking defenders off the d5 Pawn. After White gets his dark-squared Bishop out, White plays e3 and getting ready to develop his light-squared bishop. Black just gets on with his development with the moves Be7 and 0-0.

6. Nf3 Nbd7

7. Rc1 c6

Both players develop their Knights. White gets his Rook to the c-file, which may well open up soon after the c-Pawn gets exchanged. Black attempts to block White's Rook from getting too active by playing c6, which also lends more support to the d5 square.

8. Bd3 dxc4



White develops his Bishop to the best square available to it, which is d3.

Black doesn't want to exchange his central d-Pawn for White's c-Pawn, but in this case, Black sees an opportunity to gain a tempo against White's Bishop (White will have to react to the fact that his Bishop is being attacked by Black's Pawn, meaning that White will sort of being a move behind black).

Therefore, Black chooses to exchange his d-Pawn for white's c-Pawn, which will also give Black a little more space and free up the d4 square for his pieces to jump into.

9. Bxc4 Nd5

White has to recapture the Pawn, and Black jumps his Knight into d5, which is a great square for the Knight as from the center the Knight attacks a lot of squares on the board, and the Knight can jump to either side of the board at a moment's notice if it wants to.

10. Bxe7 Qxe7



Here we will stop our look at the Queen's Gambit. White has more space and a semi-open c-file to attack. Black has a very solid position and has the d4 square available for his pieces, though White will probably not allow this for long and may play either e4 or try to exchange the d5 Knight. The Queen's Gambit would be a good opening choice for you as White if you like complex, tactical, and flexible positions and don't mind playing a slightly slower game.

Queen's Gambit Accepted



To recap, the position is:

1. d4 d5
2. c4 dxc4

The Queen's Gambit Accepted has been reached after these moves are set. As I promised you earlier, this was not a true gambit, and I told you that Black couldn't hold on to their current Pawn advantage. Let me first demonstrate that to you now.

3. e3b5?

The move e3 is played if White aims to recapture the Pawn immediately, as it opens up the light-square Bishop onto the c4 square, threatening the opponent's Pawn already. Also, it helps solidify White's center, which can be useful in ensuring that White's plan goes off without any interference from Black.

The play would continue:

4. a4c6?
5. axb5cxb5?
6. Qf3!

After that dazzling Queen move, Black is going to lose a piece. This isn't mainline, but I wanted to show you how Black's best chances are to accept that the Pawn isn't going to stay around and play objectively good Chess instead.

White's most common play here is

7. 3. Nf3.

White recognizes that the Pawn on c4 is doomed and instead focuses on getting a slight lead on development. White will usually move to recapture the c4 Pawn in their upcoming turns as follows:

8. Nf3Nf6- Black's most common reply is to develop their Knight

9. E3Nc6

10. Bxc4c5

11. O-O

This position leaves both players with solid chances. White has regained its missing Pawn and has developed their pieces to effective spaces. Black, on the other hand, managed to get through the opening with equality in terms of development and space and should feel satisfied with his chances of going into the later stages of the game.

Queen's Gambit Declined



While technically, any move that is not 2. dxc4 is considered a Queen's Gambit Declined game, we will be focusing on the orthodox response as follows:

1. d4d5
2. c4e6

By moving his Pawn to e6, Black can defend his central Pawn, holding on to his control of the center. Also, this allows Black the option to develop his dark-squared Bishop along the a3-f8 diagonal, getting him one step closer to eventually castling to safety king-side.

While this is a solid and defensible position for Black to play from, and indeed many players with the Black pieces have found success here, White will try to prove that Black's light-squared Bishop does not have an effective square to find a meaningful place in the game. Black, on the other hand, will try to either release the Bishop, trade it off, or find a useful supportive outpost for it and try to use it in the end game.

Another option for Black to try is 2. c6, which is called the Slav Defense, which we will examine from Black's point of view in an

upcoming chapter.

The mainline continues thus:

3. Nc3Nf6

4. Bg5Be7

5. Nf3

White develops his queenside Knight to its ideal square behind the c4 Pawn, where it can exert great control over the middle of the board. Black takes the opportunity to get his kingside Knight into the game and help prepare his kingside castle. White tries to take advantage of black's last move by creating a pin on Black's Knight onto the Queen. Black is forced to develop his dark-squared Bishop to e7 to free Black's Knight from this pin (now if the Black Knight moves, the Bishops will face off instead of leaving the Queen exposed).

White then develops their Knight to a good square and helps solidify the Bishop's position on g5 against a potential discovered attack from the Knight against the previously undefended Bishop. A discovered attack is when the movement of one of your pieces will expose an attack from another piece behind it. These tactics are an excellent tactic to watch out for as it can come as a real shock to an unsuspecting opponent (or you if you get caught in one yourself!)

Slav Defense

1. d4 d5
2. c4 c6



Slavs are an ethnic group native to central, eastern, and southeastern Europe. Various attempts have been made to give them their own countries, usually with failed results. For example, Yugoslavia was formed to be a nation for all southern Slavic people but exploded into ethnic conflict in the 1980s and 1990s. The Soviet Union's Slavic lands broke apart into Russia, Ukraine, and Belarus in 1991. Czechoslovakia underwent a more peaceful divorce between the Czechs and the Slovaks in 1993. Even within the "Slavic" grouping, there are important differences that prevent a common sense of identity.

The Slavic lands were crushed under the yoke of an oppressive regime after World War II. This is not the only time in their history; the Slavs were oppressed. The English word "slave" has its origins from "Slav" due to the servitude suffered at the hands of Muslim conquerors in the 9th century.

These days, their circumstances are happier, and their quality of life has improved. Many Slavs maintain the tradition of playing Chess in parks, which has unfortunately been lost to much of the rest of the world. Their reputation as Chess players is still fearsome; one of the first rules this author learned as a young man was to be leery of challenging any Chess player with a Slavic-sounding name.

The Slav Defense was named because so many strong Slavic grandmasters helped to popularize it; Semyon Alapin, Alexander Alekhine, Efim Bogoljubov, and Milan Vidmar all helped develop

the theory behind the move. One upside of 2. c6 is that Black's light-squared Bishop is not locked in, unlike when 2. e6 is played to decline the Queen's Gambit.

The central tension can be relieved right away in the Exchange Variation: 3. cxd5, while other lines can become very complex. The Slav Defense has survived extensive examination from the 1920s to the present day and still retain a large and respected following.

Chigorin Defense

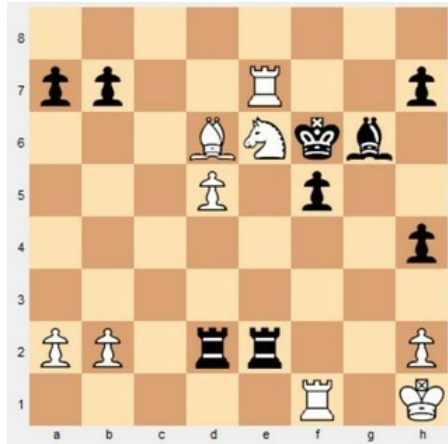
1. **d4** **d5**
2. **c4** **Nc6**



When Mikhail Chigorin first saw Chess, he didn't think much of it. But he decided it was worth another look when he finished his studies and began working for the government. He began to play at St. Petersburg's Café Dominik in his spare time and became so besotted with the game that he gave up his respectable job to pursue Chess as a vocation.

Chigorin was widely regarded as the best player in Russia in the 1880s and 1890s. After a string of impressive tournament results, he challenged Wilhelm Steinitz for the world championship. His first attempt in 1889 saw Chigorin comfortably beaten by the incumbent.

The contest was much closer in the 1892 rematch. Chigorin found himself narrowly behind eight wins to nine in the first-to-10-win contest and had a golden opportunity to level the scores in game 23. He was ahead by a Knight and had a completely winning endgame to look forward to. No one would have been at all surprised if Steinitz had resigned, such was the hopelessness of his situation. But in a stunning oversight, Chigorin moved the Bishop holding his whole position together, gifting his opponent an obvious two-move checkmate. And just like that, Steinitz had won the match.



Chigorin (playing White) played 32. Bb4 here, allowing checkmate. 32. Rxh2+ 33. Kg1 Rdg2++

Every Chess player knows the despair of working hard to earn a winning position only to throw it all away due to their carelessness. It happens to all of us, and mistakes are part of what makes us human. But tragically for Chigorin, his most egregious blunder happened at the worst possible time. It wasn't the sort of error that builds strength for having learned from it; it was the kind that one never recovers from and permanently stains a reputation. Even today, well over 100 years after the move was placed on the board, one can hardly mention Chigorin without reference to it.

Why do we blunder? The deep calculation requires us to block everything else from our minds, at times, including what we already know. But in Chigorin's case, the swigs the burly man took from the bottle of brandy by his side may have had just as much to do with it.

The Chigorin Defense was introduced later in Chigorin's career at an 1895–96 tournament in St. Petersburg. Chigorin played 2. Nc6 in response to the Queen's Gambit, much to the surprise of his American opponent Harry Pillsbury—it was an unusual move back then, and it remains so today. However, Pillsbury recovered from his shock and defeated Chigorin. Later in the same tournament, another game took place between the two. Again, Chigorin was playing Black, and again he went with 2. Nc6, but this time Chigorin emerged triumphantly.

Chigorin was known as the last of a dying breed of gambit players. While everyone around him was switching to the positional style of Steinitz, Chigorin stuck fast to his tactical, imaginative roots. A 1903 tournament held in Vienna required everyone to play the King's Gambit, and Chigorin won, handily.

Chigorin also contributed greatly to the development of Chess in Russia. He founded a club in St. Petersburg, traveled around the country to teach the game, and wrote columns for several magazines. He is regarded by many as the inspiration for the Soviet school of chess, which came to dominate the game in the second half of the 20th century. But for all his study, for all his tournament wins, for all else he did, Chigorin is famous primarily for that one crucial mistake in 1892. Oh, Chess can be a cruel mistress.

Semi-Closed Games

English Opening



This is considered one of the simplest openings currently available. White pushes his Pawn to c4 to grab space in the center and the queenside. If Black plays d5, White will have the option to play d4 and convert the game into the Queen's Gambit.

Black has three main choices:

1. c5
1. e5
1. Nf6.

The Symmetrical Variation

1. c5

Black copies the first move of his opponent. Play might continue:

2. Nc3 Nc6
3. Nf3 Nf6

4. d3 d6
5. g3 g6
6. Bg2 Bg7
7. 0-0 0-0.

Black can achieve a solid position just by copying White's moves. However, he must break the symmetry at some point. White's right to move first can be converted into a decisive advantage if the symmetry will be kept for a long time.

The Reversed Sicilian:

1. e5
2. This move aims to prevent 2. d4 and grab some space in the kingside. Besides, the Bishop on f8 acquired an open diagonal.
3. G3–White wants to cement his control over the d5-square. He will place his Bishop on g2 during his next move.
4. Nf6–Black develops a Knight and starts to fight for the d5-square.
5. Bg2–The Bishop is placed on the long diagonal. It can become extremely strong if Black does not close the center.
- 6.1 c6–This move increases Black's control over the d5-square. It also restricts the power of the g2-Bishop.
- 7 Nf3–Since the a8-h1 diagonal has been blocked, White will just continue his development. 4. e3 followed by 5. Ne2 is also good.
8. Qc7–The Pawn on e5 must be defended.
9. 0-0–White has castled his King. The Rook on f1 can be transferred to e1.
10. Be7–Black makes a natural Bishop move.

Normally, White pushes his queenside Pawns forward to acquire more space. Black, however, should focus on the center. He also needs to complete his development as soon as possible.

11. 2.3 1Nf6

Black develops his Knight early. The position can be converted into the variations discussed previously if Black will play c5 or e5 later. Play might continue:

12. Nc3–The Knight fights for the d5-square.

13. e6–Black opens the diagonal for his f8-Bishop because he wants to hide his King as soon as he can.

14. Nf3 – White makes another natural move. As a general rule, you should develop your Knights before your Bishops.

15. Bb4–Black develops a piece and threatens to ruin White's Pawn structure.

16. E3–White ignores the threat. He continues to develop his pieces by vacating the e2-square for his bishop.

17. Bxc3–Black disrupts the Pawn configuration of the enemy camp.

18. Bxc3–Despite their ugly appearance, White's queenside Pawns are doing an excellent job. The Pawn on c4 controls b5 and fights for d5. The Pawn on c3 claims the b4- and d4-squares. Meanwhile, the c1-Bishop can be transferred to b2 or a3, depending on White's preferences.

19. 0-0–Black completes his kingside development.

20. Ba3–The Bishop attacks the Rook on f8. By doing so, White gets a free move to develop another piece.

21. Re8–The Rook is transferred to the e-file to support the advance of the e6-Pawn.

22. Bd3–White develops his light-squared Bishop and prepares to castle. Move 7. D4 is also good; it prevents Black from advancing the Pawn on e6.

In this opening, White tries to take advantage of the open b-file. He pressures the queenside by placing both of his Rooks there. Black, however, must defend against White's queenside assault and prepare his counterattack in the center of the board.

Dutch Defense



Moves: 1. d4 f5.

The Dutch defense is regarded as the competitive retort by Black to White's opening. This opening gives Black the chance to start an assault on White's kingside throughout this game. But this attack leads to the f7 square of this shameful getting an easy target to its White. This disadvantage is readily overcome by castling the King.

This is 1 opening that promotes competitive moves out of both players. Also, this makes the game even more intriguing and exciting. Despite its multiple advantages, this opening may also be a double-edged sword for shameful since you open yourself up from a fast checkmate if you are not attentive and so are playing against an expert White.

These are a few of the widely used openings. I am confident that you're amazed and motivated after studying these intriguing openings. I'm confident you're waiting to test them out on another game. The value of a fantastic opening can never be stressed enough. A fantastic opening can most surely alter the destiny of this game; hence you must have an understanding of these several openings.

Flank Ohoopenings

A flank opening is typified by initial moves on either flank. This opening style makes use of pieces on the side of the board to control the central area instead of advancing Pawns on the center.

Larsen's Opening

1. b3



Jørgen Bent Larsen was an imaginative Danish grandmaster with a penchant for offbeat openings. Samuel Reshevsky said of him: "He is a firm believer in the value of surprise. Consequently, he often resorts to dubious variations of various openings. He also likes to complicate positions even though it may involve considerable risk. He has a great deal of confidence in his game and fears no-one."

The opening that bears Larsen's name is a prime example of his unorthodox style. Larsen was inspired to try 1. B3 by the play of Aron Nimzowitsch, who, however, preferred the b-Pawn push on the move two after first playing 1. Nf3. Larsen used the immediate 1. B3 often enough to get his name associated with it, thanks to his high profile and the move's relative unpopularity with anyone else.

Besides "Larsen's Opening," 1. B3 has been called the purely descriptive "Queen's Fianchetto Opening" and the playful "Baby

Orangutan—" the latter moniker due to 1. B4 is known as the "Orangutan Opening" (see the later chapter in the book for why), and 1. B3 is representing a lesser Pawn advance than the Orangutan proper.

A fianchettoed Queen's Bishop can be an asset for White, but it grants Black a lot of freedom to be proactive in the center. This was, in fact, part of Larsen's unusual philosophy: if Black expects to rely on their well-memorized opening responses, he can find himself at a loss when granted the initiative unexpectedly. Modern players remain skeptical of Larsen's Opening, but the move has a certain shock value and isn't completely devoid of threats.

Larsen was frequently mentioned alongside Bobby Fischer as the only players from the West that the elite Soviet players feared during the height of their 20th-century Chess dominance. In the 1970 USSR vs. Rest of the World match, Larsen played for the Rest of the World on board 1 (ahead of Fischer) and achieved a positive 2 ½ points out of 4. During the "1970 Interzonal Tournament," Larsen was the only man to beat Bobby Fischer in 23 games, but Fischer crushed Larsen in the semifinals of the subsequent 1971 candidate's tournament by 6–0.

Réti's Opening

The Réti Opening is introduced by the classical moves:

1. Nf3 d5
2. c4



In this opening, White develops his kingside Knight by placing it on a good square where it prevents Black from establishing a good center control with 1. e5.

The move will likewise prepare White for castling and for a kingside fianchetto, which will exert huge pressure on the center along the light square diagonal.

After 2.c4, Black has the following options:

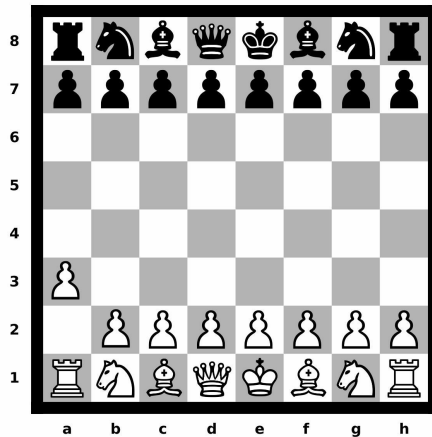
2. e6 or 2. c6	Hold and defend the d5-Pawn.
2. dxc4	Concede the d5 square by capturing White's Pawn
2. d4	Push the Pawn.

If Black elects to capture the Pawn, White can easily regain the Pawn with 3. e4 or 3. e3, which gives him more options for development. Other options for White in this line are 3. Qa4+ or 3. Na3. Hence, a Pawn capture with 2. dxc4 is not the most popular option for Black.

Irregular Openings

Most Famous Ones

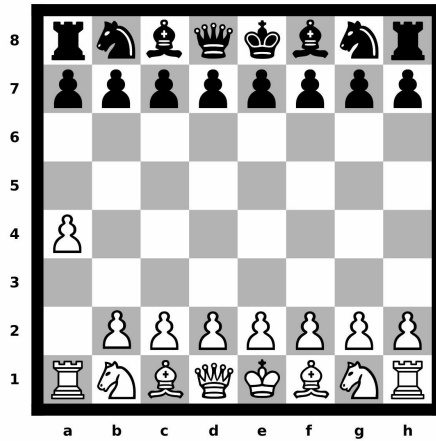
Anderssen's Opening



This is an unusual opening that is named after a German Chess master called Adolf Anderssen. He famously used the move 3 times in his matches against Paul Morphy in 1858, resulting in a win, a draw, and a loss.

- Pros: It is an opening move that is used by those who prefer to play as Black rather than White because it provides a reactive style of play.
- Cons: Statistically, White wins more often than Black, but this move effectively hands back that first-move advantage.

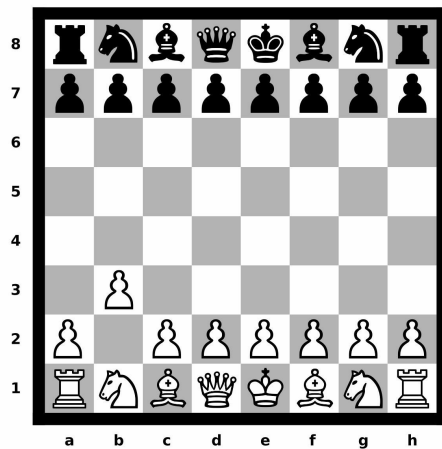
Ware's Opening



This move is named after a US Chess player called Preston Ware, who is famous for his unorthodox openings

- Pros: It enables the Rook to enter into the game early.
- Cons: Generally, Rooks are not useful early on in a game because they need space to move around, and it will quickly become a target.

Nimzowitsch-Larsen's Attack



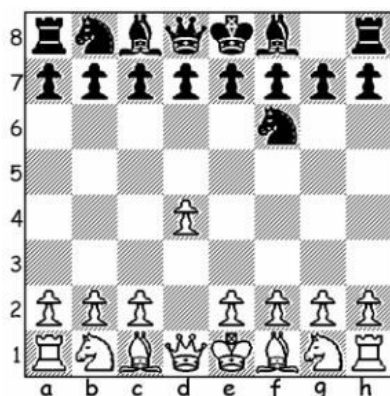
This move is named after a Danish man called Bent Larsen. He famously used this opening with a lot of success because it wasn't studied as extensively as other openings at the time.

- Pros: It enables the Bishop to control a long diagonal on the next turn.
- Cons: It's quite predictable that the Bishop will move on the next turn, and this is a slow way to build up an attack.

CHAPTER 10:

Talking About the Indian Defense

These are a class of openings that feature the moves: 1. d4 Nf6. When White uses the Queen's Pawn opening to start the game, instead of following his lead, Black decides to counter in an unsymmetrical approach. The name was derived from an Indian variation of the game that does not permit the double Pawn move. This results in much more usage of Knight development. The Indian Defenses are categorized into the hypermodern class. White gets the chance to dominate the center for the most part, while Black aims to undermine and ultimately destroys it.



The Nimzo's Indian Defense

This move follows 1. d4 Nf6, followed by 2. c4 e6 then 3. Nc3 Bb4 sequence. This opening was developed and popularized by Aron Nimzowitsch.

He was one of the pioneers of the Hypermodern School of Chess. Hypermodernism was established in the early twentieth century and is based on the following counterintuitive notions:

1. The best way to control the center of the board is by using non-Pawn pieces.

2. You should encourage your opponent to establish a pawn-dominance at the center. This formation will become vulnerable to attack once it has been overextended.

3. It is impossible to break down Chess into a simple set of principles; it is dynamic and fluid.

4. The Nimzo Indian opening is one of the most common hypermodern openings. Black can maintain a flexible structure by not playing his Pawns at the center. This provides him with several counter-attacking opportunities. The b4 Bishop will usually be traded with the Knight it captures, leading to a multiplication of the c Pawns of White, a weakness.



The King's Indian Defense

The sequence of the King's Indian defense is:

1. d4 Nf6

2. c4g6

3. Bg7.

This opening was once regarded as unsafe but soon gained fame and respect in the thirty's.

The King's Indian Defense is said to be riskier and more aggressive

than the Nimzo Indian. The opening is extremely complicated and has been used by many top players extensively, including Fischer and Kasparov.

The center can be locked down in this opening, with Black having the advantage of kingside, while White gets the advantage of queenside. Interesting spectacles can follow, with Black aiming to infiltrate the King and White swooping down and tormenting the defenseless queenside.



The Queen's Indian Defense



The Queen's Indian defense is achieved through steps 1. d4 Nf6, 2. c4 e6, 3 Nf3 b6. Black aims to fianchetto the Bishop beside his Queen and weaken White's dominance at the center from a distance. Black is allowed to establish a strong position that is hard to crack. When used in combination, the Queen's Indian and the Nimzo-Indian defense make a complete set of defense against the Queen's Pawn opening.

Tactics to Support Your Strategy

Chess is more about methods. Therefore, you have to improve your Chess method. "Chess is ninety-nine percent strategic," stated Richard Teichmann, a celebrated German Chess instructor, in 1908, and he couldn't be more correct.

Tactics play a major role in all Chess video games and are the vital factors of any method. An approach is a general sport plan, sentences approximately in which you need to be at any factor throughout the match. The tactic is used to enforce a method. Your opponent will no longer sit down and watch you lead your approach without objections. The tactic is used to force your opponent just to accept your actions. The tactic suggests one or more movements to benefit a short-time period advantage. These are fundamental steps in advancing a well-known strategy.

Many processes can be memorized or learned and applied if necessary. By setting greater techniques, the player's arsenal becomes stronger. Learning new processes, if you have to work on tactics and what aggregate of tactics works satisfactorily collectively, is a non-stop activity for the duration of a player's life. Here are a few common processes that are worth practicing:

Battery Attack

When you think of Battery Attack, imagine a regular electric battery. Each battery is powered by electric cells. If you want more control, you have to acquire extra cells. In Chess, a battery attack is formed on the rows (ranks and files) by gathering Rooks and Queen, while, diagonally, a Bishop and a Queen are stacked. Unless this is done, the opponent wields more power.

Both the players can use different pieces in their battery attacks. However, assume the White battery includes 2 Rooks at the same time as the Black battery includes 2 Rooks and a Queen. Black has a stronger battery, and White is smart to consolidate his 2 Rooks

and thus, prevent an assault.

Block

The block is a shielding tactic and is used whenever a Bishop, a Rook, or an opposing Queen manages to govern their King. In such circumstances, you may try to wiggle through with the help of your Pawns or other pieces to the center of the opponent's attacking unit and the King-take a look at the Block and shield the King at least temporarily.

Be aware, and even if your Block unit includes the King or other infantry or support devices, the attacker may determine to marvel the blocker in a sacrificial maneuver that has been recorded to remove some of your King's defense.

Authorization

It is also called "easy cleaning," which better describes what's happening here. Imagine you need to establish your hold on a selected square to reinforce the assault you ride. The problem here is that one of your pieces is already in that square.

The issue right here is that transferring that piece ends in its recording. However, due to the superior function, you may get via getting the other piece in that square, it miles worth "clearing" that block of the piece, accepting its sacrifice, to compensate for the harm you need. If the answer to this is positive, you may decide to go ahead with the move.

Decoy

Decoy includes sending a rifle or sniper rifle to a particular area as a sacrifice to capture the enemy. After that, your "real" aim is reached, as the "wait" piece gives you the threat to seize the enemy King or exploit every other major part of your rival (normally the Queen).

Deviation

Imagine throwing a stone with sufficient pressure at the back of it on every other rook. When it strikes, a stone with much less strength "deviates" from its resting function. In Chess, you can

create an attack, and there is enough weight at the back of it (as helping pieces) to assault the enemy's function as a sure factor, and this forces your real target, simply because the king's enemy, to escape from your current attack. The "lost" King moves away from the attacked square and places you in a stronger role. The famous continuous Checkmate is called "Leg all's Mate," which includes Deflection.

Discovery of the Attack

This tactic requires the cooperation of 2 pieces. One can be in the front of the other; one at the backs of the hidden unit is ready to be observed or "discovered." At the chosen moment, the piece moves forward-essentially to release an attack to another Pawn/enemy piece, and the last tune is revealed, attacking every other Pawn or enemy part (this is not the King's enemy) (more on this in the next tactic).

Following the attack, the opponent would have to choose to shop or attack the pedestrian to shop. Another attack will attack you. On a defensive note, earlier than making the following move, read the painting and observe your opposition's pieces if you see portions within the neighboring squares (as nicely as each is sitting diagonally, aspect by way of aspect), the first appearance back separately and comply with the down line of the military on the path of your navy. If you hit one in all your portions and if the enemy's enemy is within a variety of your other forces, your opponent may try to smash you with a complete-blown assault.

Discovery Revealed

It consists of principles similar to the attack detection standard. The main assessment is that the adversary of the ruler is one of the portions assaulted. Since the King is assaulted, his position will be compromised. This implies the King has to be protected no matter what. The checks were meant to capture the "other" adversary casualty.

Fork Attack

At the factor, while a Pawn or piece assaults (at least two) for

devices with a solitary move, it is known as a "fork attack." And It may be "relative" or "outright." It should be mention that the relative forks assault as a minimum of two foe units, but no longer the adversary ruler.

O outright forks attack at the least adversary units, and this time, one of the foes' pieces is the ruler. At this point, while this is a relative assault, the participant can pick which piece to spare and which to depart helpless earlier than the aggressor.

At the point when this is an outright attack, the participant's top piece ought to be protected, as in taking a look at. The Pawn/exclusive/pieces are assaulted by way of their destiny.

Conclusion

By reading this book, you have gained a basic understanding of Chess openings, and you now know how to properly start a Chess game and improve your chances of winning.

When it comes to Chess, "strategy" is the description for the game. Throughout the whole game, one is continually evaluating moves, both for their short-term benefits and their long-term place, within your overall strategy. From the opening to the endgame, the strategic plan is what helps you to beat your opponent, allowing you to create a checkmate.

This game doesn't just provide strategic mental stimulation; it also has a long history dating back to before the 6th century. As a part of the social fabric of many cultures, it has stood the test of time, tying together humanity with a game of strategy.

You have to realize that this is just an introductory book about Chess. Every point we have presented to you up to this point in this book are those we deem important to you as a beginner. There is no need to fill your head with more information that may end up leaving you more confused than you were before you picked up this book to read.

So, what should you do with the information you have gotten so far? You should put it into practice. Get yourself a chessboard and get familiar with all its components. Try and memorize all the squares, ranks, and files. Once you are done doing that, the next thing you should do is to arrange the Chess pieces on the board correctly.

Start by playing with yourself; you will need to play the White and Black pieces yourself. This is a great way to perfect a new skill you just learned. The more you practice with an actual chessboard, the more you will master how the different pieces move on the board. While playing, make sure you apply all the techniques you have learned in this book. Make use of forks, pins, and the many other techniques we have talked about.

If you cannot get your physical chessboard immediately, another

good way to practice what you have learned is to download a Chess game on your mobile phone. There are many free mobile Chess games you can download and start playing immediately. Just visit the app store for your mobile operating system, type Chess into the search bar, and download one of the games that will pop up in the search results.

Some online Chess games will allow you to pair with another player online. Once you have paired with someone, you can compete with this person and win virtual points. Participating in such competitions is a great way to sharpen your skills.

However, when you are just starting, I would recommend that you shun online competitions entirely. You need to learn on your own first before engaging in competitions. Many mobile Chess games allow you to play with the system as your opponent, and that's one of the easiest ways to learn how to play Chess.

Open the game you have downloaded, select the option that allows you to play with the system, choose a side, either White or Black, and then start playing. When doing so, you should not only pay attention to what you are playing, but you should also pay attention to the moves that the system is making against you. You will learn a lot from the system's moves. Keep practicing and improving your skills, and don't forget that Chess can be quite addictive.

Remember, this book has given you the basic foundation you need; it is left for you to leverage this foundation and turn yourself into a Chess master. That being said, there are tons of materials you can find on some of the moves, techniques, tactics, defense methods, etc., that we have introduced in this book. As you play more, you will grow inquisitive, and this is what will make you try to seek out more information on how to surmount a particular challenge you face.

Chess is a complex game, and mastering it takes a lot more than just reading about it. Playing, losing, and learning are the best ways to improve your game. So, pick out your favorite openings and read about them several times to make sure you fully understand the theory behind them and remember the sequence of moves that comprise them. Do not forget to put what you have learned to

practice by playing games.

By now, you know how important it is to create a strategy right from the beginning of a match and follow it through to a devastating conclusion. Take your Chess skills to the next level by knowing what not to do and make sure the win is in your pocket. Various opening moves and tactics, along with strong middle-game evaluations, endgame follow-through, can get you to a win. But along the way, you have to use a plan and follow it to the end. No plan when playing Chess puts you into a position of weakness with your opponent, and a sound plan can put you in a position of strength. While you have to react to your opponent's moves, remember they are also attempting to execute their plan to a successful conclusion. To get that checkmate, you just have to execute yours better! Thank you, and best of luck with your Chess.